

Victorian Britain and the World (1815–1907)

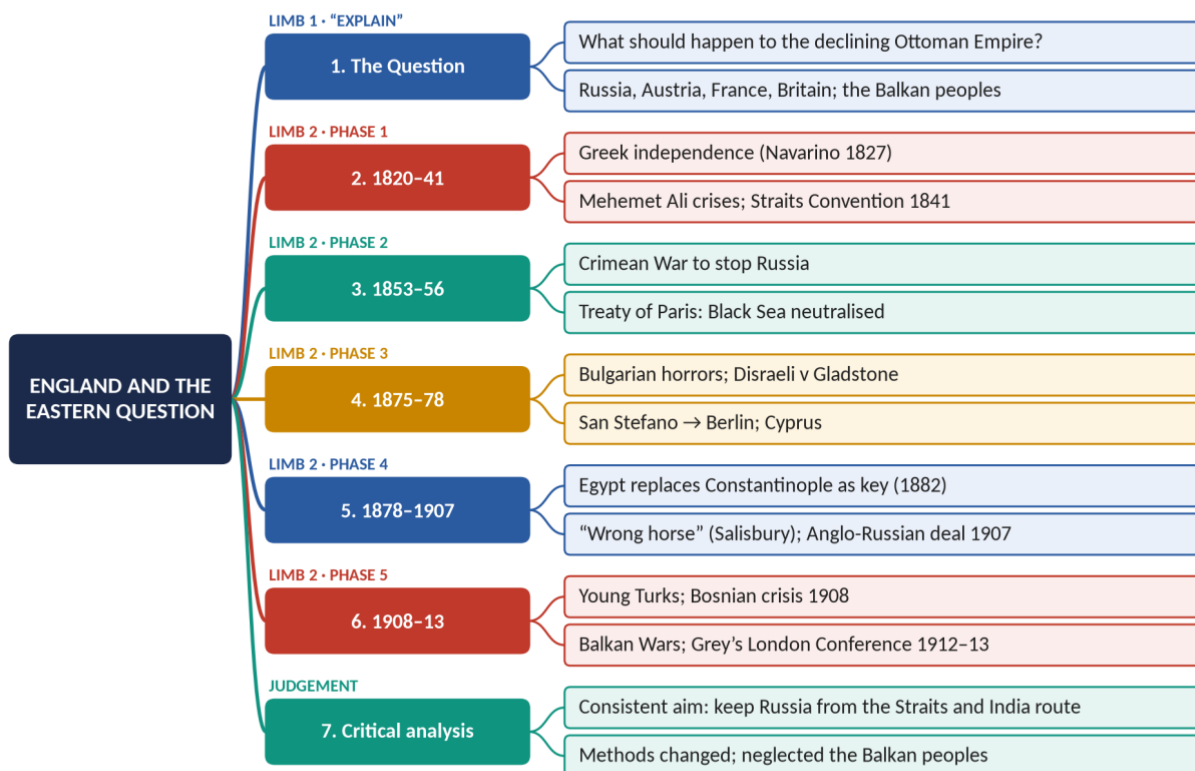
Every past question on Palmerston, the Eastern Question, the Crimean War, Disraeli and Gladstone, and Splendid Isolation — answered in full, in simple words, with answer maps

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2017 · Q6 · SECTION B

Explain the Eastern Question and critically analyse the attitude of England towards this question from 1820 to 1913.

KEY WORDS “Explain the Eastern Question” · “attitude of England” · “1820 to 1913” · “critically analyse”

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Define and explain the Question: the decline of Turkey and the powers' rivalry. (2) England's attitude, phase by phase, 1820–1913 — how it changed and why — with a judgement.

**VERDICT**

England's aim — to keep Russia away from the Straits and the route to India — stayed constant; its method moved from propping up Turkey to securing Egypt and finally to agreement with Russia.

All 11 past items (2015–2026): ten full answers and one short note; the four past MCQs solved; five predicted questions with outlines.

Topic 6 of 10 · companion to T6KB (the Knowledge Base)

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HOW TO USE THIS · Updating the contents

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How to Use These Answers

#	Paper	Question (short)	Answer
1	2015 P-I Q7	Palmerston: "Radical and Jingo, but at heart neither Whig nor Tory"	Answer 1
2	2015 P-II Q2	Palmerston: conservative at home, liberal abroad	Answer 2
3	2016 Q4	Palmerston: more successful as Foreign Minister than as PM	Answer 3
4	2017 Q6	The Eastern Question; England's attitude 1820–1913	Answer 4
5	2015 P-II Q5	The Crimean War: background and results	Answer 5
6	2016 Q8(b)	Short note: the Treaty of Berlin	Short note
7	2015 P-II Q4	Gladstone and Disraeli: characters and policies, esp. foreign	Answer 6
8	2016 Q5	Disraeli's policy and "Peace with Honour"	Answer 7
9	2015 P-II Q7	Splendid Isolation: why adopted, how abandoned	Answer 8
10	2018 Q6	How isolation was halted; its positive and negative aspects	Answer 9
11	2023 Q4	Why isolation; your opinion — right or detrimental?	Answer 10

Every answer has: the question as set · its **answer map** · **decoding the question** (what the examiner wants, in plain words) · a **model answer** with numbered headings, figures and a verdict · **why this answer scores**.

TRAP — DO NOT FALL INTO IT · Three Palmerston questions, three Isolation questions — never the same answer

Palmerston: 2015 asks **what he was** (labels), 2015 again asks about **home v abroad**, 2016 about **Foreign Secretary v Prime Minister**. **Splendid Isolation:** 2015 asks **why and how abandoned**, 2018 **how halted and its merits**, 2023 **why and your opinion**. The facts are the same (T6KB Chapters 2 and 7); the headings must come from each question's own words.

HOW TO USE THIS · If you are new to this topic

Read **T6KB Part Zero** first — above all **Britain's five interests** (0.3). Nearly every answer below is built on them. Every hard word is explained again inside the answers.

Answer 1 · Palmerston: Radical and Jingo, Neither Whig nor Tory

THE QUESTION · CSS 2015 · Q7 · Paper I · 20 marks

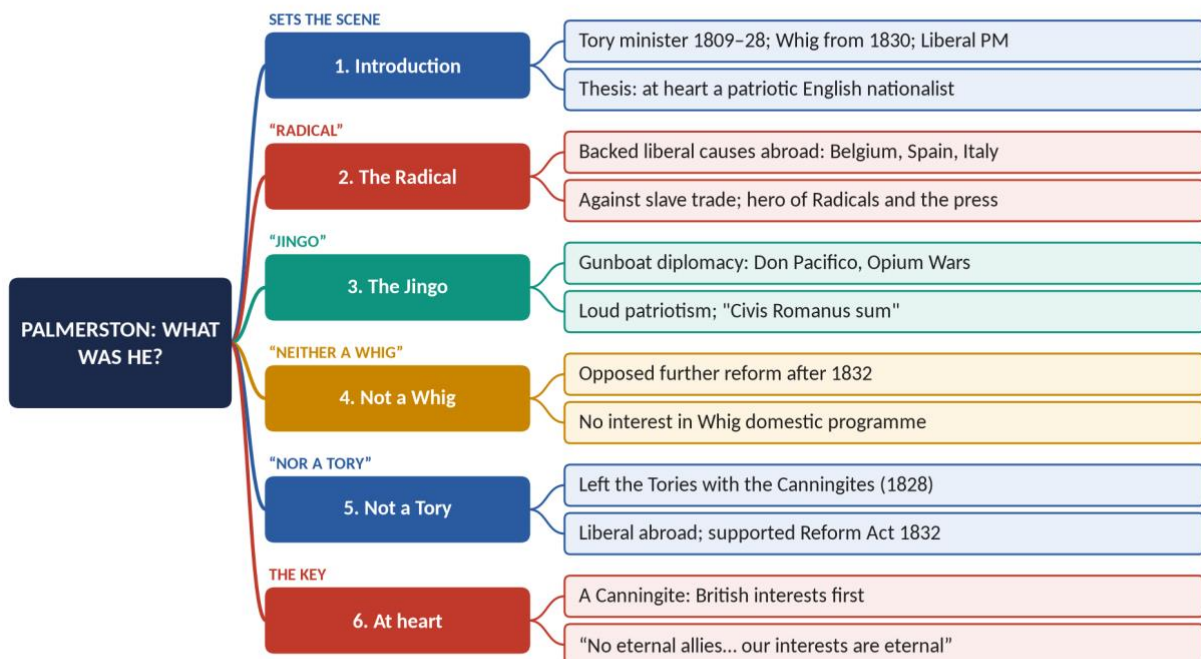
'Palmerston was at once a Radical and Jingo, but at heart neither a Whig nor a Tory.' Elucidate.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2015 · PAPER I · Q7

"Palmerston was at once a Radical and Jingo, but at heart neither a Whig nor a Tory." Elucidate.

KEY WORDS "Radical" · "Jingo" · "neither a Whig nor a Tory" · "Elucidate"

IT DEMANDS Elucidate = make clear. Explain each label (Radical, Jingo, Whig, Tory), show with evidence in what sense each fits or does not fit, and say what Palmerston was "at heart".



VERDICT

Palmerston was Radical in his sympathies abroad and Jingo in his methods, but his only true party was England: he served Tories, Whigs and Liberals alike in the cause of British interests.

Figure 1 · The answer map for CSS 2015 · Q7 · Paper I: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"**Elucidate**" = make clear, explain. The statement uses four labels. **Radical** = someone who wanted big liberal change. **Jingo** = a loud, aggressive patriot (from a song of 1878). **Whig** and **Tory** = the two old parties. So: explain in what sense Palmerston was **Radical**, in what sense **Jingo**, why he was **not really a Whig**, why he was **not really a Tory**, and what he was "**at heart**".

The model answer

Introduction

Lord Palmerston (1784–1865) was the most famous British statesman of the mid-nineteenth century: Foreign Secretary for most of **1830–51** and Prime Minister for most of **1855–65**. Yet he is hard to place in a party. He began as a minister in **Tory** governments, served the **Whigs** for twenty years and became the first leader of the **Liberal Party**. The statement that he was "at once a Radical and Jingo, but at heart neither a Whig nor a Tory" is a clever summary. This answer argues that it is **largely correct**: his sympathies abroad were Radical, his methods were Jingo, and his real loyalty was to neither party but to **British interests and prestige** — he was, at heart, a **Canningite patriot**.

(1) Understanding the four labels

Label	Meaning in the 19th century
Radical	A reformer who wanted wide change: democracy, religious equality, support for liberal and national movements abroad.
Jingo	A loud, aggressive patriot who likes to threaten force — from the 1878 music-hall song "by Jingo". (The word came after Palmerston, but it describes him well.)
Whig	The aristocratic reforming party: parliamentary and religious reform at home, cautious liberalism.
Tory	The party of the Crown, the Church, the landed interest and order; hostile to reform.

(2) His political journey

- **1807–28**: a **Tory** minister — for almost twenty years **Secretary at War**, an administrative post, taking little part in great debates.
- **1828**: he left Wellington's government with the **Canningites** — the liberal followers of Canning.
- **1830**: he joined **Grey's Whig** government as **Foreign Secretary**.
- **1859**: he became the first Prime Minister of the new **Liberal Party**.

This journey itself shows that party labels meant little to him.

(3) Palmerston the Radical

In **foreign affairs**, Palmerston took the side Radicals liked:

1. **Belgium** (1830–39): he helped the Belgians win independence from the Dutch king.
2. **Spain and Portugal** (1834): his **Quadruple Alliance** backed the **liberal constitutional** queens against absolutist pretenders.
3. **1848–50**: he welcomed the liberal revolutions, protected the Hungarian leader **Kossuth** and other refugees in Turkey against Austria and Russia, and praised the workers who attacked the brutal Austrian general **Haynau**.
4. **Italy** (1859–60): as Prime Minister he supported **Italian unification**.

5. **The slave trade:** he used the navy to hunt slave ships and forced treaties on other nations.
6. **Public opinion:** like the Radicals, he appealed to the **press** and the **people** over the heads of the Court and the aristocracy. Radical newspapers cheered him, and the Court and the conservative powers of Europe hated him.

(4) Palmerston the Jingo

His **methods** were those of an aggressive patriot:

1. **Gunboat diplomacy:** the navy blockaded **Greece** over the **Don Pacifico** affair (1850).
2. **"Civis Romanus sum":** in his famous speech he said that a British subject, like a Roman citizen, should be protected by **"the watchful eye and the strong arm of England"** anywhere in the world.
3. **Wars against China:** the **Opium War** (1839–42) and the **Arrow War** (1856–60), fought to force trade on China.
4. **Threats and bluster:** against France in 1840, against the USA over the **Trent** (1861), and — without any power to act — against Prussia over **Denmark** (1864).
5. **Popular nationalism:** he was the idol of the music halls and the popular press — a model for later jingoism.

(5) Why he was not, at heart, a Whig

- The Whigs' great cause was **domestic reform** — Parliament, the Church, the law. Palmerston cared little for it.
- He accepted the **1832 Reform Act** but then **opposed** further reform; as Prime Minister (1859–65) he blocked it: "there is really nothing to be done".
- He did not share the Whig aristocrats' **caution** abroad — his colleagues (and the Queen) often thought him reckless.

(6) Why he was not, at heart, a Tory

- He **left** the Tories in **1828**.
- He supported **Catholic Emancipation** and the **Reform Act of 1832** — both opposed by most Tories.
- His support for **liberal** movements abroad was the opposite of the Tory tradition of supporting established monarchs.
- The **Conservatives** under Derby and Disraeli were his opponents for the last twenty years of his life.

(7) What was he "at heart"?

- **A Canningite:** like **Canning**, he put **British interests** first, supported liberal causes when they helped Britain, and appealed to public opinion.
- **A patriot above party:** "We have no eternal allies, and we have no perpetual enemies. Our interests are eternal and perpetual, and those interests it is our duty to follow" (1848).

- **Conservative at home:** in domestic matters his instincts were those of an eighteenth-century aristocrat — which is why some called him "a Tory at home".

KEY IDEA · The paradox resolved

Palmerston's Radicalism and his Jingoism were two sides of **one** thing: **English nationalism**. He backed liberal causes because liberal states were Britain's natural friends, and he used force because he believed British power should be felt. Neither party label captures this; "patriot" does.

VERDICT · Conclusion

The statement is accurate. Palmerston was Radical in his sympathy for liberal and national movements abroad and in his appeal to public opinion; he was Jingo in his gunboats and his boasting of British power. But he was neither a true Whig, since he cared nothing for domestic reform, nor a true Tory, since he had left the Tories and backed liberalism abroad. At heart he belonged to no party: he was a patriotic statesman whose only fixed principle was the interest and prestige of England.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

It **defines all four labels** (a table) · it tests each label with **numbered evidence** · it shows his **party journey** as proof · it explains **what he was "at heart"** — the phrase most answers ignore — with the key quotation · the **key box** reconciles Radical and Jingo into one idea.

Answer 2 · Palmerston: Conservative at Home, Liberal Abroad

THE QUESTION · CSS 2015 · Q2 · Paper II · 20 marks

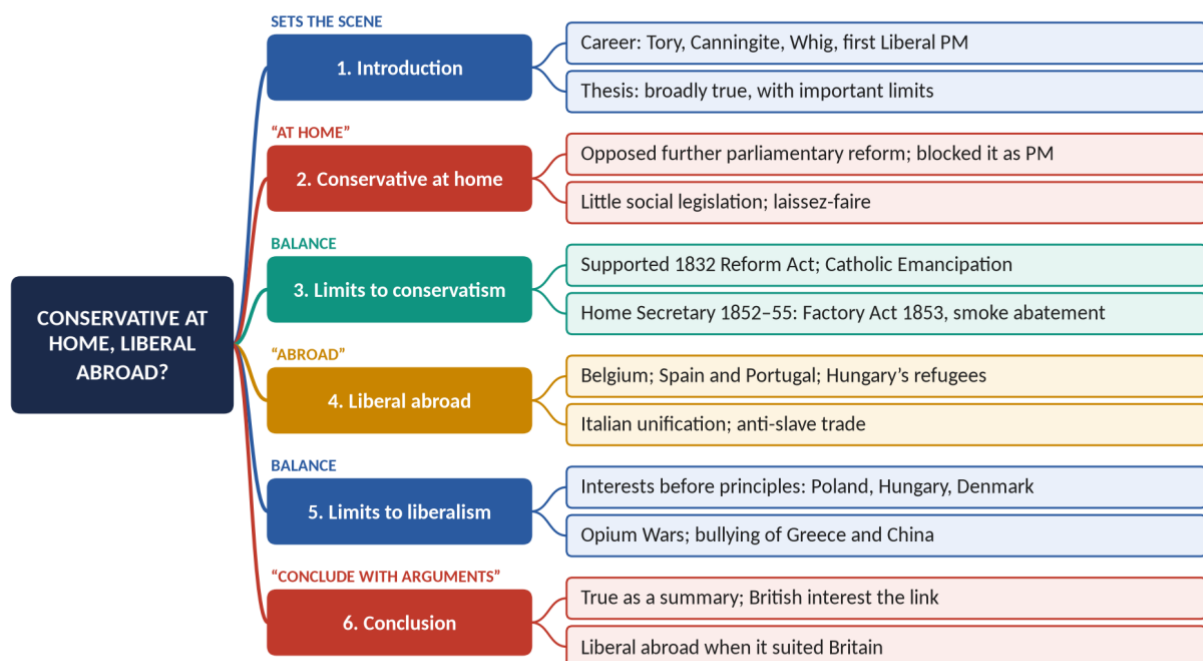
Palmerston was conservative at home and liberal abroad. Discuss and conclude with arguments.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2015 · PAPER II · Q2

Palmerston was conservative at home and liberal abroad. Discuss and conclude with arguments.

KEY WORDS "conservative at home" · "liberal abroad" · "Discuss" · "conclude"

IT DEMANDS Two halves to test with evidence: his domestic conservatism and his foreign liberalism — with the limits of each — and a reasoned conclusion.



VERDICT

The statement is largely true: Palmerston resisted change at home and backed liberal movements abroad — but in both he was guided less by principle than by his idea of British interest and prestige.

Figure 2 · The answer map for CSS 2015 · Q2 · Paper II: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"**Discuss and conclude with arguments**" = examine both halves of the statement with evidence, show the **limits** of each, and end with a firm conclusion. **Conservative at home** = resisting change in British domestic affairs. **Liberal abroad** = supporting liberal (constitutional, national, free) movements in other countries. Don't narrate his whole career — organise by the two halves.

The model answer

Introduction

It was often said of **Lord Palmerston** that he was "**a Conservative at home and a Liberal abroad**". At home he opposed further parliamentary reform and passed little social legislation; abroad he supported constitutional governments and national movements against the conservative monarchies of Europe. This answer argues that the statement is **broadly true**, but that both halves have limits — and that the link between them was not ideology but his view of **British interest**.

(1) Background: who was Palmerston?

Tory minister (1807–28); Canningite; **Whig Foreign Secretary** (1830–41, 1846–51); **Home Secretary** (1852–55); **Prime Minister** (1855–58, 1859–65), first leader of the **Liberal Party**.

(2) Conservative at home — the evidence

1. **Parliamentary reform**: after accepting the **1832 Act**, he opposed further extension of the vote. As Prime Minister he quietly **shelved** Russell's reform bills (1854, 1860). Reform came only after his death (1867).
2. **Little legislation**: his governments of 1859–65 passed almost no major domestic reform; he believed that government should interfere as little as possible (**laissez-faire**).
3. **Social attitudes**: an Irish landlord and aristocrat, he defended **property**, the **Church of England** and the **existing constitution**.
4. **Trade unions and democracy**: he distrusted popular movements at home, even while praising them abroad.
5. **Disraeli** remarked that the Conservatives had no need to take office while Palmerston was Prime Minister — he was doing their work.

(3) The limits of his conservatism

1. He supported **Catholic Emancipation** (1829) and the **Reform Act** (1832).
2. As **Home Secretary (1852–55)** he was an active reformer: the **Factory Act** of 1853 (limiting children's hours), the **Smoke Abatement Act**, reform of prisons, the ending of transportation of convicts to most colonies, and vaccination.
3. His government accepted **Gladstone's free-trade budgets** (1860) and the **Divorce Act** (1857).

(4) Liberal abroad — the evidence

1. **Belgium** (1830–39): supported the Belgian revolt; guaranteed its **independence and neutrality** (1839).
2. **The Quadruple Alliance** (1834): backed **constitutional** governments in **Spain** and **Portugal** against absolutist pretenders.

3. **Greece**: supported the young constitutional kingdom (though he also bullied it).
4. **1848–49**: sympathy with the revolutions; protection of **Hungarian and Polish refugees** in Turkey.
5. **Italy** (1859–60): diplomatic support for **Italian unification** — perhaps his most liberal act.
6. **The slave trade**: a lifelong campaign to suppress it.
7. **Opposition to the Holy Alliance**: he saw Britain as the leader of the "liberal West" against the absolutist East (Russia, Austria, Prussia).

(5) The limits of his liberalism abroad

1. **Interests before principles**: he did **nothing** for the **Hungarians** in 1849 (Austria was needed to balance Russia), the **Poles** in 1863, or the **Danes** in 1864.
2. **Turkey**: he propped up the despotic Ottoman Empire because it guarded the route to India.
3. **China**: the **Opium Wars** forced a drug trade on a weaker country — hardly liberal.
4. **Gunboat diplomacy**: the blockade of **Greece** over Don Pacifico (1850) bullied a small state.
5. **Napoleon III**: he welcomed the French coup of 1851 — the end of a republic — because a strong France under Louis Napoleon suited Britain.

	Evidence for the statement	Evidence against
At home	Blocked reform 1859–65; laissez-faire; landlord outlook	Emancipation 1829; Reform Act 1832; Home Office reforms 1853–55
Abroad	Belgium, Spain, Portugal, Italy, refugees, anti-slavery	Poland, Hungary, Denmark abandoned; Turkey propped up; Opium Wars

(6) Explaining the contrast

- At **home**, Britain already had the constitutional government he admired; he saw no need for more change, which might endanger property and order.
- **Abroad**, liberal constitutional states were likely to be **friendly to Britain**, to **trade** with it, and to **balance** the absolutist powers. Supporting them served British interests.
- So his "liberalism abroad" and "conservatism at home" came from the same root: **British interest as he understood it**.

VERDICT · Conclusion

The statement is broadly true: Palmerston resisted domestic change, especially further reform of Parliament, while supporting liberal and constitutional movements in Belgium, Spain, Portugal and Italy. But both halves need qualifying — he had been a useful reforming Home Secretary, and abroad his liberalism stopped wherever British interests stopped, as the Poles, Hungarians and Danes discovered. He was, above all, a pragmatic patriot: liberal abroad when it suited Britain, conservative at home because Britain, in his view, was already the best-governed country in the world.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Organised by the **two halves**, each with **evidence** and **limits** · a **for-and-against table** · an **explanation** of why the contrast existed · the conclusion answers "**conclude with arguments**" with a clear, reasoned view.

Answer 3 · Palmerston: Foreign Minister or Prime Minister?

THE QUESTION · CSS 2016 · Q4 · Section A · 20 marks

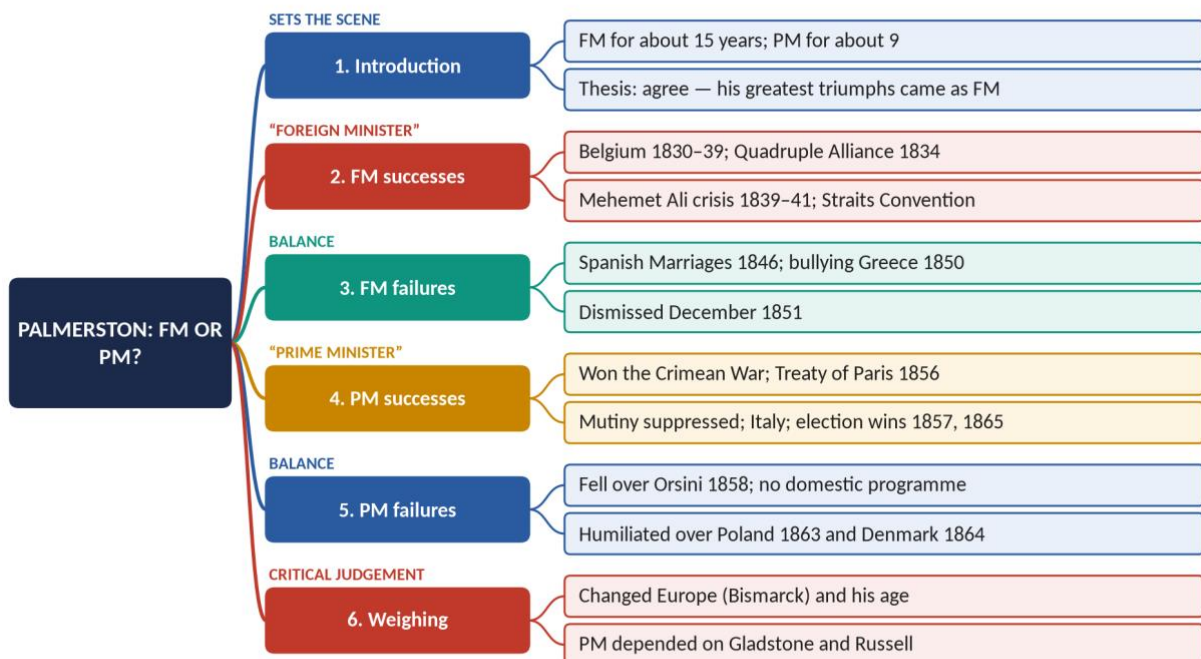
'Lord Palmerston was more successful as Foreign Minister than as Prime Minister.' Critically analyze.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2016 · Q4 · SECTION A

'Lord Palmerston was more successful as Foreign Minister than as Prime Minister.' Critically analyze.

KEY WORDS "more successful" · "Foreign Minister" · "Prime Minister" · "Critically analyze"

IT DEMANDS Compare two careers: Foreign Secretary (1830–41, 1846–51) and Prime Minister (1855–58, 1859–65). Set successes against failures in each and decide.



VERDICT

Palmerston was more successful as Foreign Secretary: there he shaped Europe; as Prime Minister he held power and won popularity, but his methods failed against Bismarck and he offered almost nothing at home.

Figure 3 · The answer map for CSS 2016 · Q4 · Section A: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"Critically analyze" = examine the statement from both sides and judge it. You must compare **two careers**: as **Foreign Secretary** (1830–34, 1835–41, 1846–51) and as **Prime Minister** (1855–58, 1859–65). Measure both by the same yardsticks — **achievements, failures, lasting results** — and decide. Remember a Prime Minister is judged on **domestic** policy too.

The model answer

Introduction

Lord Palmerston was Foreign Secretary for about **fifteen years** and Prime Minister for about **nine**. As Foreign Secretary he became the most famous diplomat in Europe; as Prime Minister he was the most popular politician in Britain. This answer argues that the statement is **correct**: Palmerston's greatest and most lasting achievements came at the Foreign Office, while as Prime Minister, though successful in keeping power, he was outplayed abroad by **Bismarck** and offered almost nothing at home.

PALMERSTON'S FOREIGN POLICY

Foreign Secretary 1830–51 (with breaks) · Prime Minister 1855–58, 1859–65

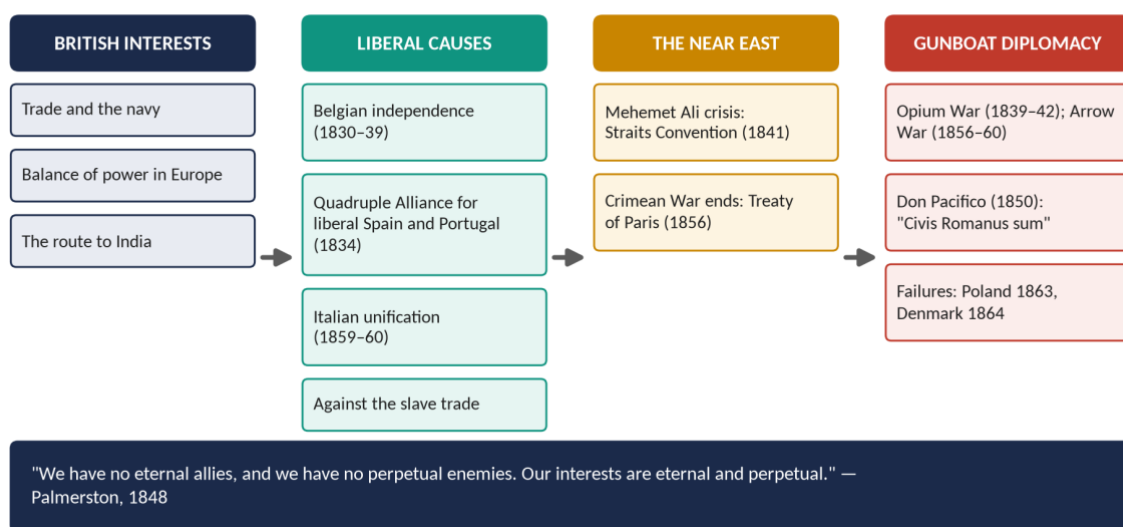


Figure 4 · Palmerston's foreign policy at a glance.

Palmerston as Foreign Secretary

(1) Successes

(a) Belgium (1830–39)

The Belgian revolt of 1830 could have let **France** take Belgium — a threat to Britain's coast. Palmerston worked through a **London Conference**, got **Leopold** made king, forced the French army out and the Dutch to accept, and secured the **Treaty of London (1839)** guaranteeing Belgian **independence and neutrality** — a settlement that lasted until 1914.

(b) The Quadruple Alliance (1834)

Britain, France, Spain and Portugal combined to support the **liberal** governments of Spain and Portugal — a "liberal West" to balance the conservative Eastern powers.

(c) The Mehemet Ali crises and the Straits (1839–41)

When the French-backed **Mehemet Ali** of Egypt threatened the Sultan, Palmerston built a coalition of Britain, Russia, Austria and Prussia, bombarded **Acre**, forced Mehemet Ali back to

Egypt and isolated France. The **Straits Convention (1841)** closed the Straits to foreign warships in peacetime and cancelled Russia's special position (Unkiar Skelessi, 1833). Historians call this his **masterpiece**.

(d) China (1839–42)

The **Opium War** and the **Treaty of Nanking (1842)** gained **Hong Kong** and opened China to British trade — a success for British interests, though morally questionable.

(e) Popularity (1850)

His **Don Pacifico** speech ("Civis Romanus sum") won a Commons vote and made him a national hero.

(2) Failures

- **The Spanish Marriages (1846)**: outwitted by Louis Philippe; the entente with France collapsed.
- **Bullying**: the blockade of **Greece** (1850) angered the other powers.
- **Clashes with the Queen and colleagues**: he sent dispatches without showing them; **dismissed** in December **1851**.

Palmerston as Prime Minister

(3) Successes

1. **The Crimean War** (1855–56): he gave the war energy, and secured the **Treaty of Paris (1856)**, which neutralised the Black Sea.
2. **India**: the **Mutiny** (1857) was suppressed; the **Government of India Act (1858)** transferred India to the Crown.
3. **China**: the **Arrow War** ended with the **Convention of Peking (1860)** and **Kowloon**.
4. **Italy** (1859–60): with Russell he supported **Italian unification** — a new friendly state.
5. **The American Civil War**: he kept Britain **neutral** and avoided war over the **Trent** (1861).
6. **Political success**: he won the elections of **1857**, **1859** and **1865**; he held the new Liberal Party together; he was hugely popular.

(4) Failures

1. **The Orsini affair (1858)**: his **Conspiracy to Murder Bill**, to please Napoleon III, was seen as bowing to France; he was **defeated** and resigned.
2. **Poland (1863)**: loud protests against Russia, no action.
3. **Denmark (1864)**: he told Parliament Denmark would "not stand alone"; when Prussia and Austria attacked, Britain did nothing. **Bismarck** had called his bluff — "**meddle and muddle**".

4. **Domestic policy:** he blocked **parliamentary reform** and offered no programme; the main achievements (the 1860 budget) were **Gladstone's**.
5. **An old man's methods:** bluster and the navy did not work against Prussia, a great land power.

(5) Comparing the two

Yardstick	As Foreign Secretary	As Prime Minister
Lasting achievements	Belgium (to 1914); Straits Convention; Hong Kong	Treaty of Paris (broken by 1871); India Act 1858; Italy
Failures	Spanish Marriages; dismissal	Orsini; Poland; Denmark; no home programme
Europe	He shaped it	Bismarck shaped it
Popularity	Rising	At its peak — elections won

(6) Critical analysis — reasons for the difference

1. **The times changed:** in the 1830s–40s Britain faced weak or divided rivals; by the 1860s it faced **Bismarck**, who knew Britain had no army to send.
2. **His methods aged:** gunboats could coerce Greece or China but not Prussia.
3. **Different jobs:** a Prime Minister must lead at home, and Palmerston had no domestic interests.
4. **Age:** he became PM at **70** and died in office at **80**.
5. **But** as PM he achieved much that a Foreign Secretary could not: winning the Crimean War, holding power, and making the Liberal Party.

VERDICT · Conclusion

The statement is correct. As Foreign Secretary, Palmerston created lasting settlements — Belgium, the Straits Convention — and made Britain's influence felt throughout Europe and Asia. As Prime Minister he won a war, several elections and great popularity, but his methods failed against Bismarck in 1864, he fell over Orsini in 1858, and he had no domestic policy. His true greatness lay at the Foreign Office.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Two careers judged by the **same yardsticks** · **successes and failures** in each, with dates · a **comparison table** · a **critical analysis** of **why** he did better as FM · a clear verdict with a note of balance.

Answer 4 · The Eastern Question and England's Attitude, 1820–1913

THE QUESTION · CSS 2017 · Q6 · Section B · 20 marks

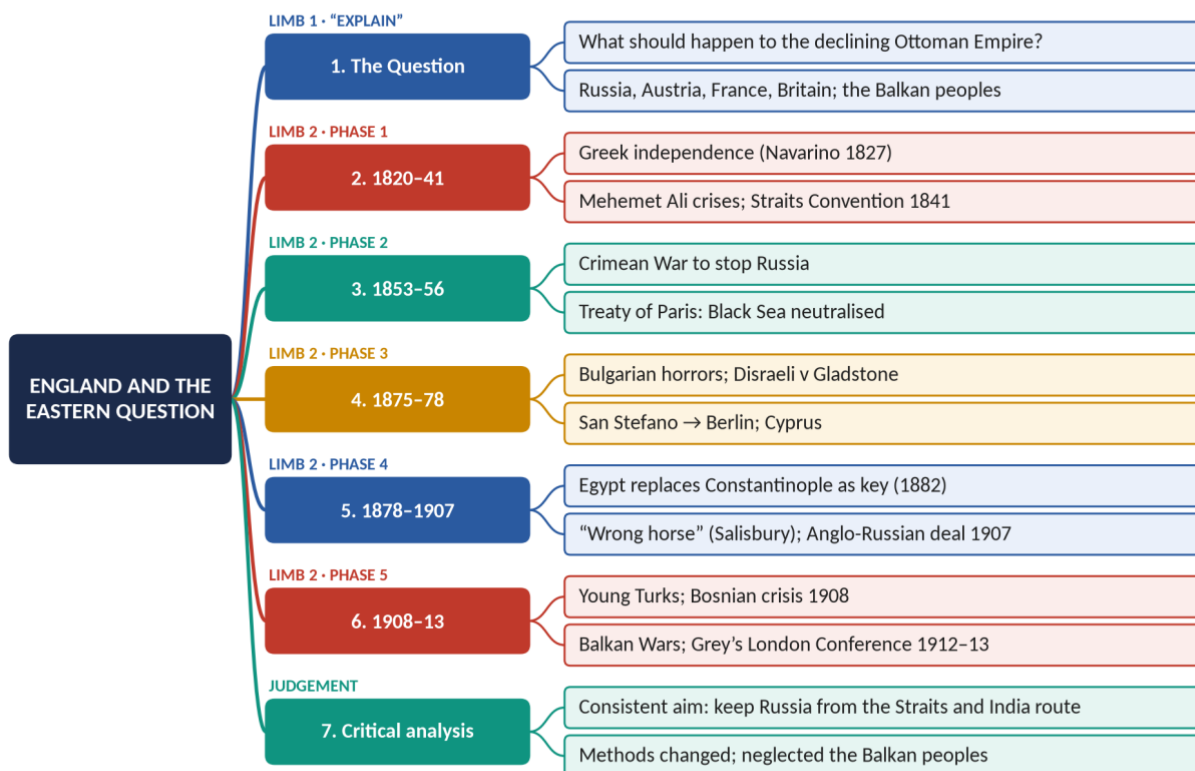
Explain the Eastern Question and critically analyse the attitude of England towards this question from 1820 to 1913.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2017 · Q6 · SECTION B

Explain the Eastern Question and critically analyse the attitude of England towards this question from 1820 to 1913.

KEY WORDS "Explain the Eastern Question" · "attitude of England" · "1820 to 1913" · "critically analyse"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Define and explain the Question: the decline of Turkey and the powers' rivalry. (2) England's attitude, phase by phase, 1820–1913 — how it changed and why — with a judgement.



VERDICT

England's aim — to keep Russia away from the Straits and the route to India — stayed constant; its method moved from propping up Turkey to securing Egypt and finally to agreement with Russia.

Figure 5 · The answer map for CSS 2017 · Q6 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "**Explain the Eastern Question**" — define it, explain why Turkey was declining, and what each Great Power wanted. (2) "**Critically analyse the attitude of England towards this question from 1820 to 1913**" — how Britain's policy changed over almost a century, **why**, and whether it was wise. A **phase-by-phase** structure is the clearest way to cover 93 years.

The model answer

Introduction

The **Eastern Question** was the great diplomatic problem of the nineteenth century: **what should happen to the declining Ottoman (Turkish) Empire**, and how the **rivalry of the Great Powers** over its lands — especially the **Balkans** and the **Straits** — could be managed without a general war. England's attitude was shaped by one constant aim: to keep **Russia** away from the Straits and the Mediterranean and so protect the **route to India**. Its methods, however, changed completely: from **propping up Turkey** (1820–78), to relying on **Egypt** and the Suez Canal (after 1882), to **agreement with Russia** (1907).

THE EASTERN QUESTION, 1820–1913

The decaying Ottoman Empire and the places where the Great Powers clashed over it



Figure 6 · The stage of the Eastern Question.

Limb 1 · Explaining the Eastern Question

(1) The decline of the Ottoman Empire

- In the sixteenth century the Ottoman Empire had reached Vienna. By 1800 it was **weak**: a backward economy, an out-of-date army, corrupt government, and provincial rulers (like **Mehemet Ali** in Egypt) who were almost independent.
- Its **Christian subjects** in the Balkans — **Greeks, Serbs, Bulgarians, Romanians** — were inspired by **nationalism** and rose for independence.
- Tsar Nicholas I called it "**the sick man of Europe**" (1853). The question was: who would inherit his lands?

(2) The interests of the powers

- **Russia**: warm-water access through the **Straits**; protection of **Orthodox** Christians; leadership of the **Slavs**; perhaps **Constantinople** itself.
- **Austria**: stop Russia in the Balkans; keep **Slav nationalism** out of its own empire.
- **France**: influence in **Egypt, Syria** and the **Holy Places**.
- **Britain**: stop **Russia**; protect the **route to India**, the **Mediterranean** and trade with Turkey; keep the **balance of power**.
- **Germany** (after 1871): first peace, then (under Wilhelm II) influence in Turkey — the **Berlin–Baghdad railway**.

(3) Why it was dangerous

Every Balkan revolt or Turkish defeat threatened to bring Russia and Austria, or Russia and Britain, into conflict — as in **1854, 1878** and finally **1914**.

Limb 2 · England's attitude, 1820–1913

(4) Phase 1 · 1820–1841: preserving Turkey against Russia, France and Egypt

- **The Greek revolt (1821)**: public opinion was pro-Greek. **Canning** cooperated with Russia (1826) and France (**Treaty of London, 1827**) to control the outcome and prevent Russia acting alone. The allied fleets destroyed the Turkish-Egyptian fleet at **Navarino (1827)**; Greece became independent (1830–32).
- **The first Mehemet Ali crisis (1831–33)**: Britain was busy with Belgium; the Sultan turned to Russia — the **Treaty of Unkiar Skelessi (1833)**.
- **The second crisis (1839–41)**: **Palmerston** united the powers (except France), bombarded **Acre**, forced Mehemet Ali back to Egypt, and secured the **Straits Convention (1841)** — the Straits closed to foreign warships in peacetime.
- **Attitude**: Turkey must be **preserved**; Russian and French influence checked.

(5) Phase 2 · 1853–1856: war to preserve Turkey

When Russia demanded the right to protect Orthodox Christians and occupied the **Principalities** (1853), Britain and France fought the **Crimean War** (1854–56). The **Treaty**

of Paris (1856) neutralised the **Black Sea** and guaranteed Turkey's independence and integrity. (See Answer 5.)

- **Attitude:** preserve Turkey **by force**.

(6) Phase 3 · 1856–1878: preserving Turkey, but a divided nation

- **1870–71:** Russia repudiated the Black Sea clauses; Gladstone accepted this at the **London Conference** (1871).
- **1875–78:** the great Eastern crisis. Turkish massacres in Bulgaria (**1876**) — the "**Bulgarian horrors**" — split British opinion: **Gladstone** demanded the Turks leave "**bag and baggage**"; **Disraeli** held that British interests required Turkey to be preserved.
- When Russia defeated Turkey and imposed **San Stefano** (1878), Disraeli threatened war; the **Congress of Berlin** (**1878**) cut back Russia's gains, and Britain took **Cyprus** to protect Turkey in Asia. (See the short note and Answer 7.)
- **Attitude:** still preserve Turkey — but British opinion was now **morally divided**.

(7) Phase 4 · 1878–1907: Egypt replaces Constantinople

- **The Suez Canal shares** (1875) and the **occupation of Egypt** (**1882**) gave Britain a new, safer guard for the route to India. Constantinople mattered less.
- **The Armenian massacres** (**1894–96**) ended British sympathy for the Sultan. **Salisbury** admitted in **1897** that Britain had "**put its money on the wrong horse**" in the Crimean War.
- **Germany** replaced Britain as Turkey's friend (the Kaiser's visits; the Baghdad railway).
- **The Anglo-Russian Convention** (**1907**): Britain and Russia settled their rivalries in Persia, Afghanistan and Tibet — **partners**, not enemies.
- **Attitude:** Turkey no longer essential; Britain relies on **Egypt**, the **navy** and **agreement with Russia**.

(8) Phase 5 · 1908–1913: mediator in the last crises

- **1908:** the **Young Turk** revolution; Austria **annexed Bosnia**, humiliating Russia and Serbia — Britain protested but did not act.
- **1912–13:** the **Balkan Wars** drove Turkey almost out of Europe. **Sir Edward Grey** chaired the **London Conference of Ambassadors**, which created **Albania** and produced the **Treaty of London** (May **1913**); Britain and Germany cooperated to keep the peace.
- **Attitude:** **mediation** and the Concert of Europe — but the Balkans remained the "**powder keg**" that exploded at **Sarajevo** in **1914**.

Phase	England's attitude
1820–41	Preserve Turkey; control Greek independence; check Russia and France
1853–56	Fight Russia to preserve Turkey
1856–78	Preserve Turkey; Berlin; opinion divided
1878–1907	Egypt replaces Turkey; agreement with Russia
1908–13	Mediation (London Conference)

(9) Critical analysis

(a) Strengths

- **Consistency of aim:** for a century Britain kept Russia out of the Straits and the Mediterranean.
- **Flexibility of method:** when propping up Turkey became too costly and immoral, Britain found other means (Egypt, agreement with Russia).
- **Diplomacy often worked:** the Straits Convention (1841), Berlin (1878) and the London Conference (1913) settled crises without British war.

(b) Weaknesses

- **Moral cost:** Britain propped up a corrupt and sometimes murderous empire (Bulgaria 1876, Armenia 1894–96).
- **The Balkan peoples** were treated as pieces in a great-power game; their grievances fed the wars of 1912–14.
- **The Crimean War** was costly and its gains short-lived.
- **Over-fear of Russia:** Salisbury himself admitted the "wrong horse".

VERDICT · Conclusion

The Eastern Question was the problem of the dying Ottoman Empire and of the Great Powers' rivalry over its inheritance. From 1820 to 1913 England's attitude was consistent in purpose — to keep Russia away from the Straits and to protect the route to India — but changed in method: from preserving Turkey by diplomacy and war, to securing Egypt, to partnership with Russia and mediation in the Balkans. It protected British interests effectively, but at a moral cost and without solving the Balkan problem that led to the First World War.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Limb 1 **defines and explains** (decline + each power's aims) · Limb 2 covers **all 93 years** in **five clear phases** with dates · a **summary table** · a genuine **critical analysis** — strengths and weaknesses — rather than narrative alone.

Answer 5 · The Crimean War: Background and Results

THE QUESTION · CSS 2015 · Q5 · Paper II · 20 marks

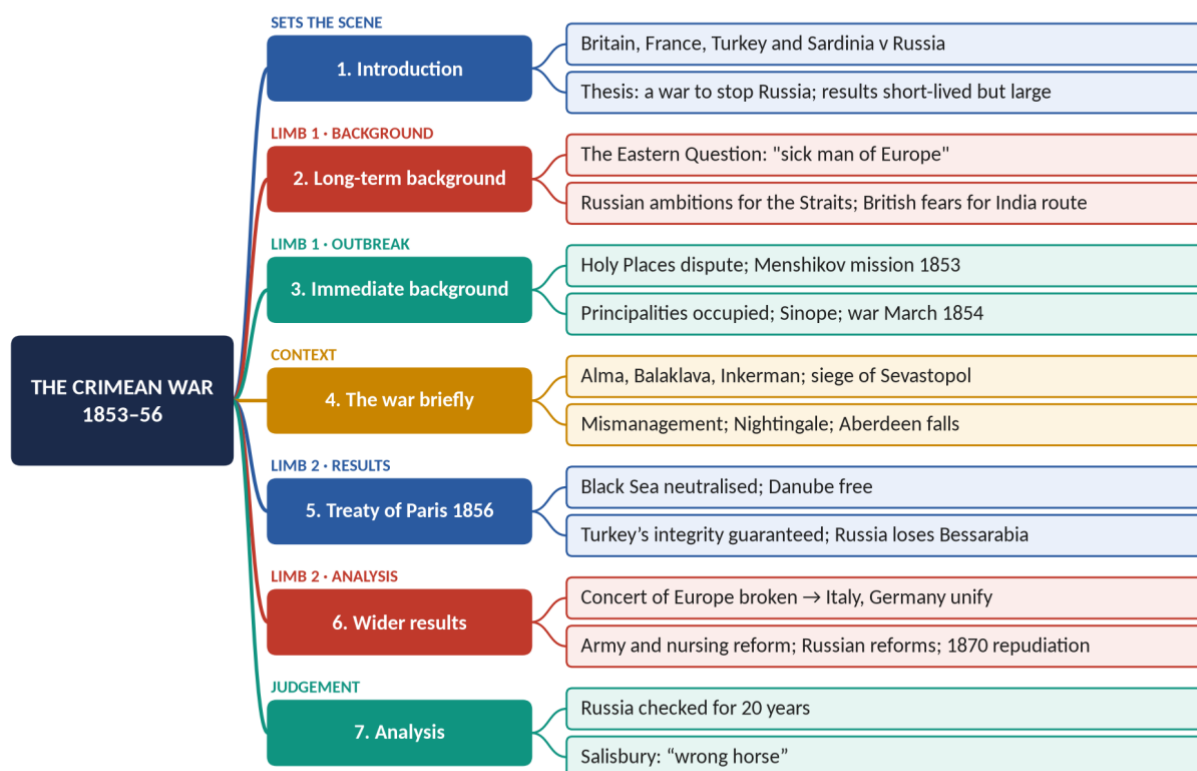
What was the background in the context of which the Crimean War broke out? Discuss and analyze the results that followed the cessation of hostilities.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2015 · PAPER II · Q5

What was the background in the context of which the Crimean War broke out? Discuss and analyze the results that followed the cessation of hostilities.

KEY WORDS "background" · "Crimean War broke out" · "results" · "cessation of hostilities"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Background — long-term and immediate causes. (2) Results after the war ended: the Treaty of Paris and the wider consequences — analysed, not just listed.



VERDICT

The Crimean War grew from the Eastern Question and Anglo-Russian rivalry; its peace checked Russia only briefly, but by breaking the Concert of Europe it opened the way to the unification of Italy and Germany.

Figure 7 · The answer map for CSS 2015 · Q5 · Paper II: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "What was the background in the context of which the Crimean War broke out?" — the **long-term** background (the Eastern Question, Anglo-Russian rivalry) and the **immediate** events of 1852–54. (2) "Discuss and analyze the results that followed the cessation of hostilities" — the **Treaty of Paris** and the **consequences** for Russia, Turkey, Europe and Britain, analysed (were they lasting? important?). The fighting itself needs only a short section.

The model answer

Introduction

The **Crimean War (1853–56)** was fought by **Britain, France, the Ottoman Empire** and later **Sardinia** against **Russia**. It grew out of the **Eastern Question** — Russia's ambition to dominate the declining Turkish Empire, and Britain's determination to stop it. The war itself was notorious for mismanagement, but its results were important: the **Treaty of Paris** checked Russia only briefly, while the breakdown of the **Concert of Europe** opened the way to the unification of Italy and Germany.

THE CRIMEAN WAR, 1853–56

Numbered: 1 Alma (20 Sept 1854) · 2 Balaklava (25 Oct 1854) · 3 Inkerman (5 Nov 1854) · 4 Sevastopol (fell 9 Sept 1855)



Figure 8 · The Crimean War: the Black Sea theatre.

Limb 1 · The background

(1) The long-term background

(a) The Eastern Question

The Ottoman Empire was weak and seemed near collapse. Tsar **Nicholas I** told the British ambassador in **1853**: "We have a **sick man** on our hands." He proposed dividing its lands with Britain in advance; Britain refused.

(b) Russian ambitions

Russia wanted control or free use of the **Straits**, influence over the Sultan's **Orthodox Christians** (about a third of his subjects), and leadership of the **Slav** peoples.

(c) British fears

- A Russian fleet passing the Straits could threaten **Malta**, **Egypt** and the **route to India**.
- Russian domination of Turkey would upset the **balance of power**.
- British opinion was fiercely **Russophobic**: Russia was the tyrant that had crushed **Poland** (1831) and **Hungary** (1849).
- Britain's trade with Turkey was growing.

(d) French ambitions

Napoleon III, the new French emperor, wanted **prestige**, the support of French Catholics, and to break up the conservative alliance of Russia, Austria and Prussia that had kept France down since 1815.

(2) The immediate background, 1852–1854

1. **The Holy Places (1852)**: Catholic and Orthodox monks quarrelled over the keys and the star of the **Church of the Nativity** in **Bethlehem**. Under French pressure the Sultan favoured the Catholics — an insult to Russia.
2. **The Menshikov mission (February–May 1853)**: Nicholas sent Prince **Menshikov** to demand a treaty recognising Russia as **protector of all Orthodox Christians** in the empire — which would have given Russia a right to interfere everywhere. The Sultan, encouraged by the British ambassador **Stratford Canning** (Lord Stratford de Redcliffe), refused.
3. **The Principalities (July 1853)**: Russian troops occupied **Moldavia and Wallachia**. The British and French fleets moved to the **Dardanelles**.
4. **The Vienna Note (July 1853)**: the powers' compromise was accepted by Russia but rejected by Turkey.
5. **War between Turkey and Russia (October 1853)**.
6. **Sinope (30 November 1853)**: the Russian fleet destroyed a Turkish squadron at anchor. The British press called it a "**massacre**", and public opinion demanded war.
7. The allied fleets entered the Black Sea; Russia refused to leave the Principalities; **Britain and France declared war on 28 March 1854**.

KEY IDEA · A war of drift

The British Prime Minister, **Lord Aberdeen**, wanted peace, but his cabinet was divided, opinion was inflamed, and each step (moving the fleets) made retreat harder. The war was the result of **mutual suspicion, miscalculation and public pressure** as much as of deliberate policy.

(3) The war in brief

- The allies landed in the **Crimea** to capture **Sevastopol**, Russia's Black Sea naval base: victories at the **Alma** (20 Sept 1854), **Balaklava** (25 Oct — the **Charge of the Light Brigade**) and **Inkerman** (5 Nov).
- The terrible **winter of 1854–55**: about **21,000** British soldiers died in the war, about **16,000** of them from **disease**. *The Times* reporter **William Howard Russell** exposed the mismanagement; **Florence Nightingale** reformed the hospital at **Scutari**.
- **Aberdeen fell** (January 1855); **Palmerston** became Prime Minister.
- **Sevastopol fell in September 1855**. The new Tsar, **Alexander II**, accepted peace after Austria threatened to join the allies.

Limb 2 · The results**(4) The Treaty of Paris (30 March 1856)**

1. **The Black Sea neutralised**: no warships or naval arsenals on its shores.
2. **Russia ceded southern Bessarabia**, cutting it off from the mouth of the **Danube**.
3. **Free navigation of the Danube** under an international commission.
4. **Moldavia and Wallachia** self-governing under Turkish rule, guaranteed by **all** the powers.
5. Russia gave up its claim to protect the Sultan's **Christians**; the Sultan promised reforms and equal rights (the **Hatt-i Humayun**, 1856).
6. **Turkey** admitted to the **Concert of Europe**; its **independence and integrity** guaranteed.
7. **The Declaration of Paris**: rules for war at sea; privateering abolished.

(5) The results for the Eastern Question

- **Russia checked** — but only for about **fifteen years**. In **1870**, while France and Prussia were at war, Russia **repudiated** the Black Sea clauses; the **London Conference (1871)** accepted it.
- **Turkey saved but not reformed**: the promised reforms were not carried out; Christian revolts continued (1875–78).
- **Romania**: Moldavia and Wallachia elected the same prince and **united** (1859–61) — a new Balkan state.

(6) The results for Europe — the most important

- **The Concert of Europe broke down:** Russia felt betrayed by **Austria**, which it had saved in 1849 and which had threatened it in 1855. Russia no longer defended the settlement of 1815.
- This allowed **Piedmont** (Sardinia), which had joined the war to win a seat at the peace conference, to unify **Italy** (1859–61), and **Prussia** under **Bismarck** to unify **Germany** (1864–71) — both at Austria's expense, and both with Russia standing aside.
- **France** enjoyed a brief period as the leading power of Europe.

(7) The results for Britain

- **Army reform:** the scandal prepared the way for the **Cardwell reforms** (1868–74); the **Victoria Cross** was created (1856).
- **Nursing and medicine:** Nightingale's work founded modern nursing (the Nightingale School, 1860).
- **Politics:** Aberdeen's fall; Palmerston's supremacy.
- **Press and opinion:** the power of the press and the telegraph in war was revealed.
- **Disillusion** with European wars: Britain fought no European war again until **1914** — part of the background to **Splendid Isolation**.

(8) The results for Russia

Defeat showed Russia's backwardness; **Alexander II** began the **Great Reforms**, including the **emancipation of the serfs** (1861) and army reform.

(9) Analysis — was the war worth it?

- **For Britain:** its aims were achieved **briefly**; the long-term benefits were small, and **Salisbury** later admitted Britain had "**put its money on the wrong horse**" (1897).
- **For Europe:** the war's greatest consequences were **unintended** — the breakdown of the Concert and the rise of Italy and Germany, which changed the balance of power far more than the Treaty of Paris.

VERDICT · Conclusion

The Crimean War broke out because the Eastern Question set Russia's ambitions against Britain's fear for the Straits and the route to India, and because a quarrel over the Holy Places, the Menshikov mission and the destruction of the Turkish fleet at Sinope led the powers to drift into war. Its immediate result, the Treaty of Paris, checked Russia only until 1870; its real results were the collapse of the Concert of Europe, the unification of Italy and Germany, the reform of Russia, and in Britain a lasting reform of the army and of nursing.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

The **background** is split into **long-term** and **immediate** causes, with dates · the war itself is **brief** · the **results** are organised by **who was affected** (the Eastern Question, Europe, Britain, Russia) and **analysed** (lasting? intended?) · the "wrong horse" quotation and the **Concert** argument show depth.

Short Note

The Treaty of Berlin (1878)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2016 · Q8(b) · Section B · short note (10 marks)

Write a short note on: Treaty of Berlin

The **Treaty of Berlin (13 July 1878)** was signed at the **Congress of Berlin**, chaired by the German Chancellor **Bismarck** as "**honest broker**". It revised the **Treaty of San Stefano** (3 March 1878), which **Russia** had imposed on defeated **Turkey** after the **Russo-Turkish War** (1877–78).

- **Why a congress:** San Stefano created a huge "**Big Bulgaria**" reaching the Aegean, which **Britain** and **Austria-Hungary** saw as a Russian satellite. **Disraeli** threatened war (the fleet at Constantinople; Indian troops to Malta); Salisbury's **Circular** demanded a revision by all the powers.
- **Terms:**
 - **Bulgaria** cut into **three**: a small self-governing Bulgaria (north); **Eastern Rumelia** (self-governing under the Sultan); **Macedonia** returned to Turkey.
 - **Serbia, Montenegro** and **Romania** fully **independent**.
 - **Bosnia and Herzegovina** occupied and administered by **Austria-Hungary**.
 - **Russia** kept southern Bessarabia and **Kars** and **Batum**.
 - **Britain** gained **Cyprus** (by the separate **Cyprus Convention** with Turkey).
- **Significance:** Disraeli claimed "**Peace with Honour**"; a European war was avoided and Russia checked. **But** Russia was humiliated and blamed Germany (leading to Bismarck's alliance with Austria in 1879); the Balkan peoples' wishes were ignored — Bulgaria absorbed Eastern Rumelia in **1885**, Austria's annexation of **Bosnia (1908)** led to the **Sarajevo** assassination (**1914**).

In one line: a diplomatic triumph for Disraeli that kept the peace for a generation but planted the seeds of the First World War in the Balkans.

Answer 6 · Gladstone and Disraeli: Characters and Policies, Especially in Foreign Affairs

THE QUESTION · CSS 2015 · Q4 · Paper II · 20 marks

Analyze the characters and policies of Gladstone and Disraeli with special reference to foreign affairs.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2015 · PAPER II · Q4

Analyze the characters and policies of Gladstone and Disraeli with special reference to foreign affairs.

KEY WORDS "characters" · "policies" · "Gladstone and Disraeli" · "special reference to foreign affairs"

IT DEMANDS Compare the two men: their characters first, then their policies — mainly foreign (Eastern Question, empire, Egypt, South Africa), with domestic policy only briefly. Analyse, don't just narrate.

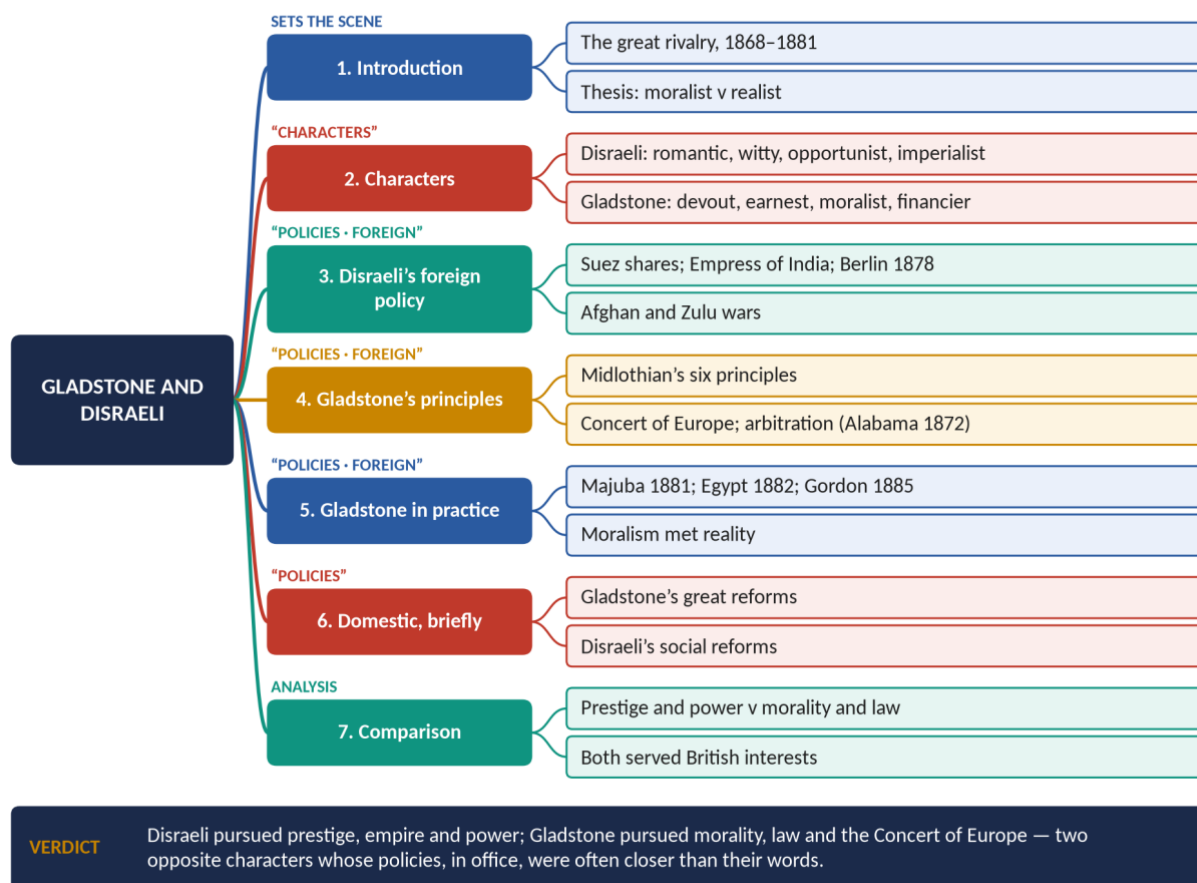


Figure 9 · The answer map for CSS 2015 · Q4 · Paper II: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"**Analyze the characters and policies**" = examine **both** men's personalities and **both** men's policies, comparing them. "**With special reference to foreign affairs**" = most of the policy section must be on **foreign and imperial** policy (the Eastern Question, empire, Egypt, South Africa); domestic policy only briefly. Link **character** to **policy** — how each man's personality shaped his foreign policy.

The model answer

Introduction

From **1868 to 1881** British politics was dominated by the rivalry of two extraordinary men: the Conservative **Benjamin Disraeli** and the Liberal **William Ewart Gladstone**. They alternated as Prime Minister (Disraeli 1868 and **1874–80**; Gladstone **1868–74** and **1880–85**) and disliked each other intensely. Their characters could hardly have been more different, and so were their ideas of foreign policy: Disraeli sought **prestige, power and empire**; Gladstone sought **morality, law and the Concert of Europe**. Yet in office each was often forced to act much like the other.

The characters

(1) Disraeli (1804–81)

- **Background:** born into a **Jewish** family, baptised an Anglican at **12**; no public school or university; a **novelist** (*Vivian Grey*, *Coningsby*, *Sybil*) and a dandy with debts — an outsider who climbed "to the top of the greasy pole".
- **Personality:** witty, romantic, theatrical, charming and flattering; an **opportunist** who loved power and political combat.
- **Beliefs:** the **nation**, the **Crown**, the **empire** and "One Nation" — national unity across classes.
- **The Queen:** her favourite; he flattered her ("Everyone likes flattery; and when you come to royalty you should lay it on with a trowel"), made her **Empress of India**, and she made him **Earl of Beaconsfield** (1876).

(2) Gladstone (1809–98)

- **Background:** son of a rich Liverpool merchant; **Eton** and **Oxford** (a double first); a Tory, then a Peelite, then Liberal leader.
- **Personality:** earnest, intensely **religious** (a High Anglican), tireless, learned; saw politics as a **moral** and Christian duty; could seem self-righteous.
- **Beliefs:** **liberty**, **economy**, **justice**, the rights of **nations**, the public law of Europe.
- **The Queen:** she disliked him — "He speaks to me as if I were a public meeting."

	Disraeli	Gladstone
Temperament	Romantic, witty, cynical	Earnest, moral, intense
Politics as	A great game	A moral duty
Key value	Prestige and power	Justice and liberty
Style in foreign affairs	Bold strokes, secret deals, threats	Public argument, law, the Concert

The policies — foreign affairs

TWO APPROACHES TO FOREIGN POLICY

Disraeli's power politics and Gladstone's moral politics

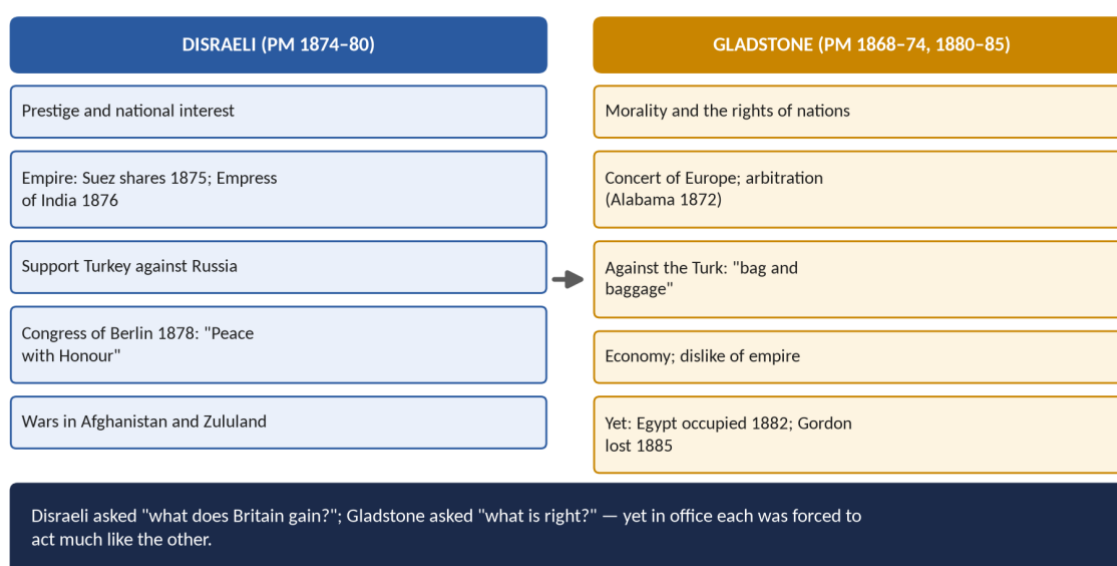


Figure 10 · Two approaches to foreign policy.

(3) Disraeli's foreign and imperial policy (1874–80)

(a) The programme

At the **Crystal Palace (1872)** Disraeli said the Conservatives would uphold the **empire** and accused the Liberals of trying to dissolve it.

(b) The Suez Canal shares (1875)

He bought the Khedive's **44 per cent** of the shares for **£4 million**, borrowed from the **Rothschilds**, to secure the **route to India**.

(c) Empress of India (1876)

The **Royal Titles Act** — a symbol of imperial power aimed at India and Russia.

(d) The Eastern crisis and Berlin (1875–78)

He supported **Turkey** against **Russia**, dismissed the **Bulgarian massacres** as "coffee-house babble", sent the fleet to **Constantinople** (1878), forced Russia to submit **San Stefano** to a

congress, and at **Berlin** (1878) cut back **Big Bulgaria** and gained **Cyprus** — "**Peace with Honour**".

(e) The forward policy

The **Second Afghan War** (1878–80) and the **Zulu War** (1879, the disaster of **Isandlwana**) — expensive and embarrassing. Gladstone called it "**Beaconsfieldism**".

(4) Gladstone's principles

In his **Midlothian** campaign (1879) Gladstone set out **six principles**: good government at home; **peace**; the **Concert of Europe**; **no needless entanglements**; the **equal rights of all nations**; foreign policy inspired by the **love of freedom**.

(5) Gladstone's foreign policy in practice

(a) First ministry (1868–74)

- **Neutrality** in the **Franco-Prussian War** (1870), with treaties protecting **Belgium**.
- Accepted Russia's repudiation of the **Black Sea** clauses at the **London Conference** (1871), insisting on the principle that treaties change only by agreement.
- **The Alabama arbitration** (1872): paid the USA **\$15.5 million** — a landmark for peaceful settlement, though critics called it weak.

(b) The Bulgarian agitation (1876)

His pamphlet ***The Bulgarian Horrors*** demanded that the Turks leave Bulgaria "**bag and baggage**" — foreign policy as a moral crusade.

(c) Second ministry (1880–85) — principle meets reality

- **South Africa**: after the defeat at **Majuba** (1881) he gave the **Transvaal** self-government — principled, but seen as humiliation.
- **Egypt**: he **bombarded Alexandria** and **occupied Egypt** (1882, Tel-el-Kebir) — the greatest imperial expansion of the decade, by the leader who attacked imperialism.
- **The Sudan**: he sent **Gordon** to evacuate Khartoum; the relief came too late; Gordon was killed (1885).
- **Penjdeh** (1885): he stood firm against Russia on the Afghan frontier.

(6) Domestic policy — briefly

- **Gladstone**: the great reforms of 1868–74 (education, civil service, army, ballot) and 1880–85 (the franchise); Irish Home Rule (Topic 5).
- **Disraeli**: the Second Reform Act (1867) and the social reforms of 1874–80 (housing, public health, trade unions).

Analysis

(7) How character shaped policy

- Disraeli's **romantic imagination** saw Britain as a great imperial power on the world stage; his **opportunism** made him ready for bold strokes like Suez.
- Gladstone's **religious conscience** made him judge foreign policy by **right and wrong**; his **financial** mind hated costly wars.

(8) The paradox of office

Issue	Disraeli	Gladstone
Words	Empire, prestige	Morality, peace
Russia	Checked at Berlin	Checked at Penjdeh
Egypt	Bought the canal shares	Occupied the country
Wars	Afghanistan, Zululand	Egypt, Sudan

Both men served the same **British interests** — the route to India, the balance of power — and in office both used force and diplomacy much alike. Their difference was greater in **language** and **spirit** than in results.

VERDICT · Conclusion

Disraeli and Gladstone were opposites in character — the romantic, witty opportunist against the earnest Christian moralist — and their foreign policies reflected it: Disraeli pursued prestige, empire and power politics, Gladstone the Concert of Europe, law and the rights of nations. Yet the pressures of British interest drove both towards similar actions: Disraeli bought the Suez Canal shares, and Gladstone occupied Egypt. Their rivalry gave Victorian politics its drama and shaped the two great traditions of British foreign policy — realism and idealism.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Characters first (with a comparison table), then **policies**, with **foreign affairs** given most space as demanded · Gladstone's **principles** set against his **practice** · the **link** between character and policy is analysed · the **paradox of office** gives a sophisticated conclusion.

Answer 7 · Disraeli's Policy and "Peace with Honour"

THE QUESTION · CSS 2016 · Q5 · Section A · 20 marks

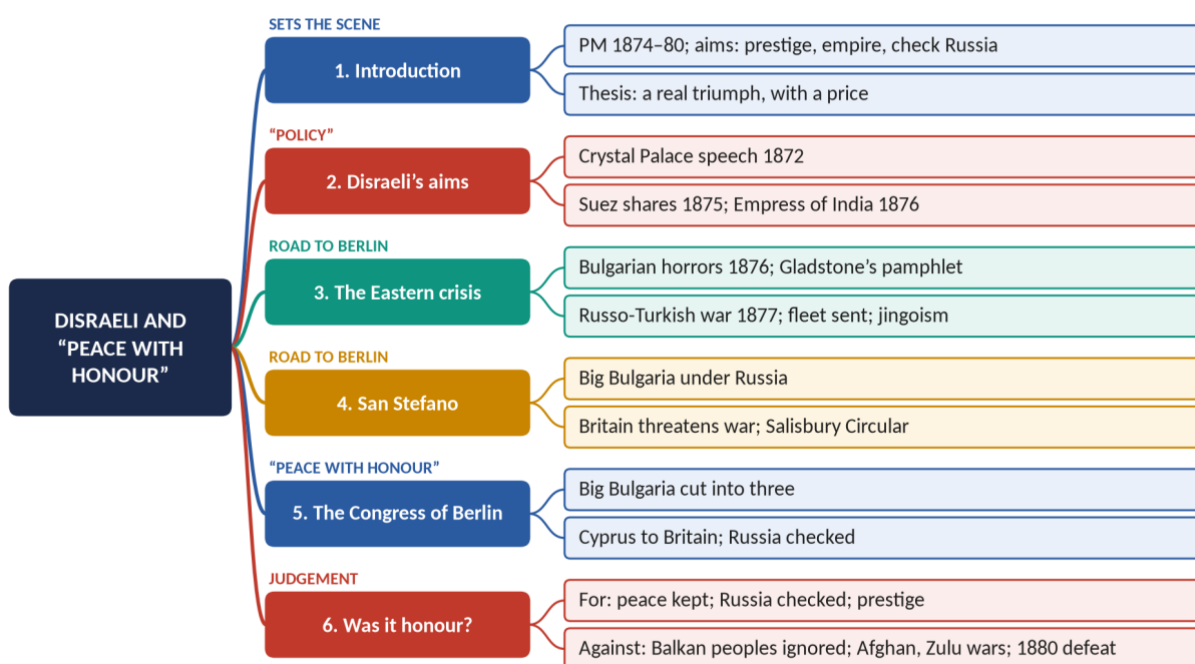
Explain the policy of Disraeli with special reference to 'Peace with Honour'.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2016 · Q5 · SECTION A

Explain the policy of Disraeli with special reference to 'Peace with Honour'.

KEY WORDS "policy of Disraeli" · "Peace with Honour"

IT DEMANDS Explain Disraeli's foreign and imperial policy in general, then centre on the Eastern crisis of 1875–78 and the Congress of Berlin, which he called "Peace with Honour". Judge whether the phrase was justified.



VERDICT

At Berlin Disraeli won peace and prestige without war, and Russia was checked — but the "honour" was Britain's, not the Balkan peoples', and the settlement stored up the conflicts of 1912–14.

Figure 11 · The answer map for CSS 2016 · Q5 · Section A: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"**Explain the policy of Disraeli**" = his policy as Prime Minister (1874–80) — mainly **foreign and imperial**. "**With special reference to 'Peace with Honour'**" = the heart of the answer is the **Eastern crisis of 1875–78** and the **Congress of Berlin**, after which Disraeli claimed "peace with honour". Explain what happened, then **judge** whether the claim was justified.

The model answer

Introduction

Benjamin Disraeli, Earl of Beaconsfield, was Conservative Prime Minister from **1874 to 1880**. His foreign policy aimed to restore Britain's **prestige**, to strengthen the **empire** and above all to **check Russia** and protect the route to India. Its high point came in **July 1878**, when he returned from the **Congress of Berlin** declaring: "**I have returned from Berlin bringing peace — but a peace I hope with honour.**" This answer explains his policy and argues that "Peace with Honour" was a real diplomatic triumph for Britain — but one bought at the expense of the Balkan peoples and followed by less honourable wars.

(1) Disraeli's aims

- **Prestige**: he believed Gladstone had let Britain's influence decline (the Alabama payment, the Black Sea).
- **Empire**: in his **Crystal Palace speech (1872)** he made the **empire** one of the three great aims of the Conservative Party.
- **Russia**: the chief threat to the **Straits** and **India**.
- **The Concert**: he wanted Britain to be a leading voice in Europe again.

(2) Imperial measures

- **The Suez Canal shares (November 1875)**: **£4 million** from the **Rothschilds** for **44 per cent** of the shares — control of the route to India.
- **The Royal Titles Act (1876)**: Victoria **Empress of India**.

(3) The Eastern crisis, 1875–77

1. **1875**: revolt in **Bosnia and Herzegovina**.
2. **1876**: a rising in **Bulgaria** was crushed with massacres by Turkish irregulars — the "**Bulgarian horrors**". Disraeli at first dismissed the reports as "**coffee-house babble**".
3. **Gladstone's** pamphlet (**September 1876**) roused the nation against the Turks — "**bag and baggage**".
4. **The Constantinople Conference** (December 1876) failed; the Sultan rejected reform.
5. **April 1877**: **Russia declared war** on Turkey. After the siege of **Plevna**, the Russians advanced to the edge of **Constantinople** (January **1878**).

(4) Britain's response — the threat of war

- The **fleet** was sent through the Dardanelles to **Constantinople (February 1878)**.
- Parliament voted **£6 million** for war preparations; **Indian troops** were moved to **Malta**; reserves called up.
- Public opinion was inflamed: "**We don't want to fight, but by Jingo if we do...**" — the birth of **jingoism**.

(5) San Stefano (3 March 1878)

Russia dictated peace to Turkey. The treaty created a huge "**Big Bulgaria**", stretching to the **Aegean Sea**, under Russian influence — a Russian foothold on the Mediterranean. Britain and Austria refused to accept it.

(6) Preparing the Congress

- **Lord Derby**, the cautious Foreign Secretary, resigned; **Lord Salisbury** replaced him and issued the **Salisbury Circular** (April 1878), demanding that the whole treaty be reviewed.
- **Secret agreements**: with **Russia** (to reduce Bulgaria), with **Austria** (on Bosnia), and with **Turkey** — the **Cyprus Convention** (June 1878): Britain would occupy **Cyprus** and defend Turkey's Asian lands against Russia.

FROM SAN STEFANO TO BERLIN, 1878

How Disraeli and the Congress rewrote Russia's peace

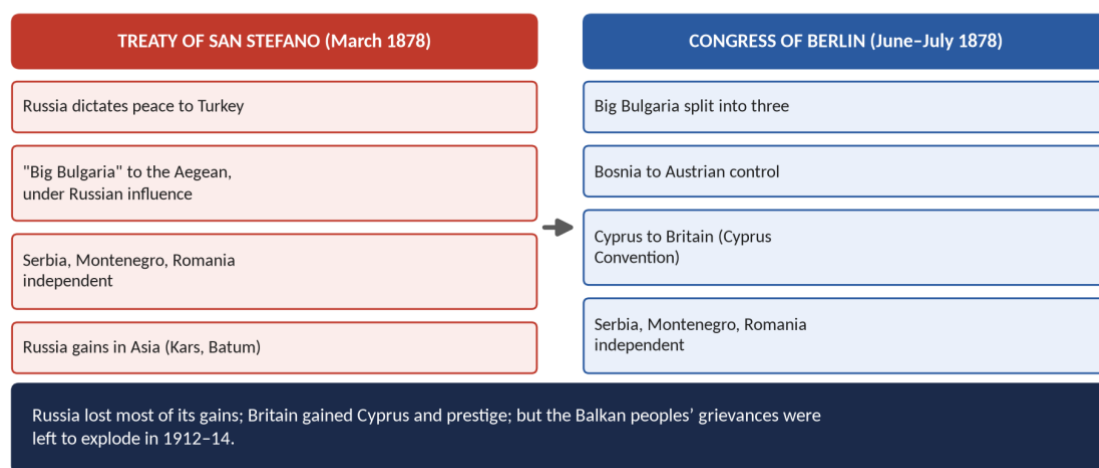


Figure 12 · From San Stefano to Berlin.

(7) The Congress of Berlin (13 June – 13 July 1878)

Chaired by **Bismarck** as "**honest broker**". Its terms:

1. **Big Bulgaria** divided into **three** — a small autonomous **Bulgaria**, **Eastern Rumelia** under Turkish rule, and **Macedonia** returned to Turkey. Russia lost its access to the Aegean.
2. **Serbia**, **Montenegro** and **Romania** independent.
3. **Bosnia and Herzegovina** occupied by **Austria-Hungary**.
4. **Russia** kept southern Bessarabia, **Kars** and **Batum**.
5. **Britain** gained **Cyprus**.

Bismarck said of Disraeli: "**The old Jew — that is the man.**" Disraeli came home to cheering crowds and refused a dukedom; the Queen gave him the **Garter**.

(8) Was it "Peace with Honour"? — the case for

1. **Peace**: war with Russia was avoided.

2. **Russia checked:** the Russian satellite on the Aegean was prevented; the Straits and the route to India were safe.
3. **Prestige:** Britain was again a leading power; Disraeli dominated the Congress.
4. **Cyprus:** a base in the eastern Mediterranean, near Suez.
5. **The Concert worked:** a crisis was settled by the powers together.

(9) The case against

1. **The Balkan peoples ignored:** Bulgarians were divided against their will (they reunited in **1885**); Bosnia was handed to Austria — the root of the **1908** crisis and the **1914** assassination at Sarajevo.
2. **Turkey not reformed:** Britain protected the Sultan whose troops had massacred the Bulgarians; the reforms promised for Macedonia and Armenia never came.
3. **Russia humiliated:** Russia blamed Germany, leading to the **Dual Alliance** (1879) and, later, to the division of Europe into blocs.
4. **The forward policy that followed:** the **Afghan War** (1878–80) and **Zulu War** (1879, Isandlwana) cost lives and money and damaged the government.
5. **The voters' verdict:** Gladstone's **Midlothian campaign** attacked "Beaconsfieldism"; the Conservatives lost the **1880** election.

VERDICT · Conclusion

Disraeli's policy aimed at prestige, empire and the containment of Russia, and at the Congress of Berlin he achieved all three without war: Big Bulgaria was broken up, Russia was kept from the Mediterranean, and Britain gained Cyprus. It was a genuine diplomatic triumph — "peace", certainly, and "honour" for Britain. But it was not honour for the Balkan peoples, whose grievances were stored up for the future, and it was followed by unnecessary wars that cost Disraeli the election of 1880.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

It explains Disraeli's **general policy** first, then centres on **1875–78** as "special reference" requires · the **sequence** from Bosnia to San Stefano to Berlin is clear and dated · **Berlin's terms** listed · "**Peace with Honour**" judged with **five points for** and **five against** · a clear, balanced verdict.

Answer 8 · Splendid Isolation: Why Adopted, How Abandoned

THE QUESTION · CSS 2015 · Q7 · Paper II · 20 marks

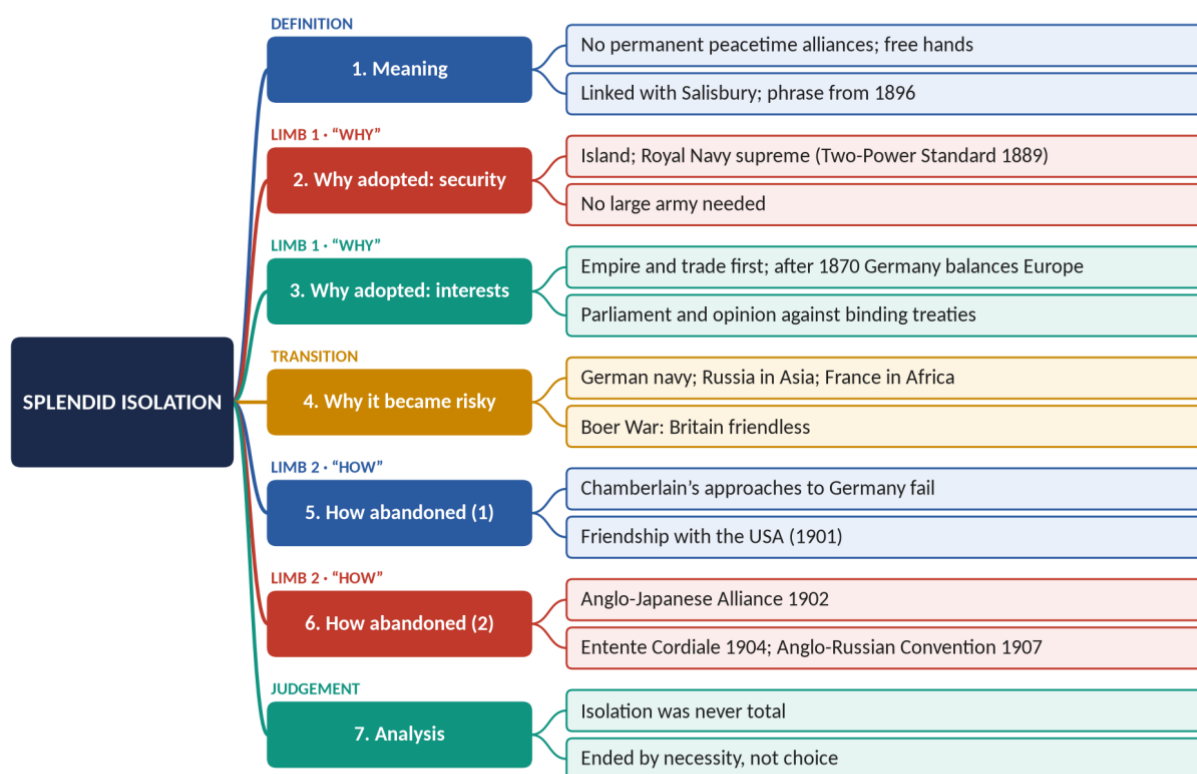
Why did Britain adopt the Policy of Splendid Isolation from 1870 onwards in external affairs? How was this policy abandoned by the end of the 19th century? Discuss and analyze.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2015 · PAPER II · Q7

Why did Britain adopt the Policy of Splendid Isolation from 1870 onwards in external affairs? How was this policy abandoned by the end of the 19th century? Discuss and analyze.

KEY WORDS "Why did Britain adopt" · "Splendid Isolation" · "from 1870" · "How was this policy abandoned"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Reasons for isolation after 1870. (2) How it was abandoned — the steps from about 1898 to 1907 (the question says "end of the century", but the process ran to 1907).



VERDICT

Britain stood aloof because its navy, empire and island position made alliances unnecessary; when rivals multiplied around 1900, it gave up isolation step by step — Japan, France, Russia.

Figure 13 · The answer map for CSS 2015 · Q7 · Paper II: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "Why did Britain adopt the Policy of Splendid Isolation from 1870 onwards?" — the **reasons**. (2) "How was this policy abandoned by the end of the 19th century?" — the **steps** (the process began in the late 1890s and was completed by 1907 — say so). "Discuss and analyze" = explain and judge. First define **Splendid Isolation** clearly.

The model answer

Introduction

Splendid Isolation was the name given to Britain's policy, in the late nineteenth century, of **avoiding permanent alliances** with other Great Powers in peacetime, so as to keep its "**free hands**". It is associated above all with **Lord Salisbury**, Prime Minister and Foreign Secretary for most of 1885–1902. Britain adopted it because its **navy, empire, wealth** and **island position** made alliances seem unnecessary and dangerous. It abandoned it between about **1898 and 1907**, when the rise of **Germany** and quarrels with **France, Russia** and the **USA** made isolation risky — through the **Anglo-Japanese Alliance** (1902), the **Entente Cordiale** (1904) and the **Anglo-Russian Convention** (1907).

SPLENDID ISOLATION: WHY, THE CRACKS, AND THE END

From free hands to the Triple Entente

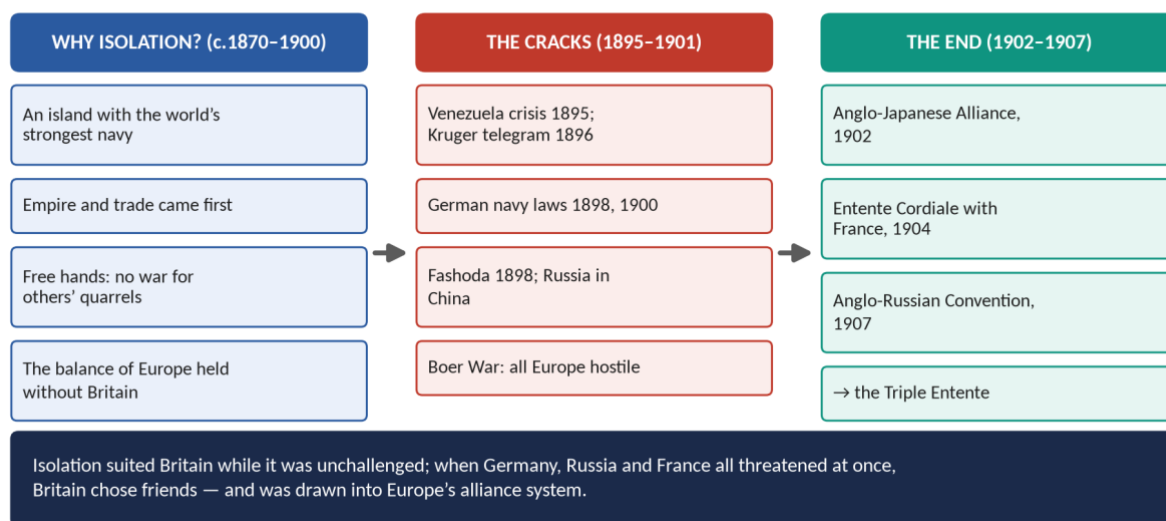


Figure 14 · Splendid Isolation: why, the cracks, and the end.

(1) What Splendid Isolation meant

- **No binding peacetime alliances** with Great Powers; freedom to decide each question on its merits.
- **Not total isolation:** Britain was active in the world, signed colonial agreements, and made limited arrangements such as the **Mediterranean Agreements (1887)** with Italy and Austria.

- **The phrase** was first used in **January 1896** by the Canadian politician **George Foster**, and then by British ministers.
- **Salisbury's image:** British policy was to "**float lazily downstream**, occasionally putting out a diplomatic boat-hook to avoid collisions".

Limb 1 · Why Britain adopted it from 1870

(2) Security: an island and a navy

- The **Channel** and the **Royal Navy** made invasion almost impossible; Britain did not need allies to defend its own soil.
- The **Naval Defence Act (1889)** set the **Two-Power Standard**: the navy must be as strong as the next **two** navies combined.

(3) Global interests

- Britain's interests were **world-wide**: India, trade routes, colonies. A European alliance might drag Britain into continental wars over issues (like **Alsace-Lorraine** or the **Balkans**) that did not concern it.

(4) The European balance after 1870

- After the **Franco-Prussian War (1870–71)** and **German unification**, **Bismarck** wanted peace and kept Europe stable through his alliances — the **Dual Alliance** (1879), the **Triple Alliance** (1882), the **Reinsurance Treaty** (1887).
- With the balance of power maintained by others, Britain could stand aside.

(5) Economic and imperial strength

- Britain was the world's greatest trading, financial and imperial power; it felt **self-sufficient**.
- Money was better spent on the **navy** than on a large army for continental alliances.

(6) Politics and public opinion

- **Parliament** would not accept secret treaties binding Britain to go to war in the future. Salisbury argued that no British government could promise what a future Parliament would do.
- **The Crimean War (1854–56)** had shown the cost of a continental war; Britain did not fight in Europe again until 1914.

(7) Confidence

Victorian Britain believed in its own greatness; alliances seemed a sign of weakness.

Limb 2 · How the policy was abandoned

(8) Why isolation became dangerous (1890–1902)

1. **Germany**: after Bismarck's fall (1890), **Kaiser Wilhelm II** pursued **Weltpolitik** (world policy). The **Kruger telegram** (January 1896) congratulated the Boers on defeating the Jameson Raid; **Tirpitz's Navy Laws** (1898, 1900) began building a fleet aimed at Britain.
2. **France and Russia** formed an **alliance** (1894) — Britain's two chief colonial rivals together.
3. **Russia** advanced into **China** (Port Arthur, 1898) and threatened India through Central Asia.
4. **France** clashed with Britain at **Fashoda** (1898).
5. **The USA** threatened war over the **Venezuela** boundary (1895).
6. **The Boer War** (1899–1902): Europe was openly hostile; the British army's early defeats showed how thinly its forces were stretched.

(9) Step 1 · Failed approaches to Germany (1898–1901)

Joseph Chamberlain, the Colonial Secretary, publicly proposed an **Anglo-German alliance** (1898, 1899, 1901). Germany demanded that Britain join the **Triple Alliance** and believed Britain could never reach agreement with France or Russia. The talks failed — a turning point.

(10) Step 2 · Friendship with the USA

The **Hay–Pauncefote Treaty** (1901) let the USA build and fortify a canal across Panama; Britain reduced its Caribbean fleet — the beginning of the lasting Anglo-American friendship.

(11) Step 3 · The Anglo-Japanese Alliance (30 January 1902)

- Signed by **Lord Lansdowne**.
- If either power was at war with **one** power in the Far East, the other would stay **neutral**; if with **two**, it would **join** its ally.
- It checked **Russia** in the Far East and allowed Britain to reduce its Pacific fleet.
- **Britain's first peacetime alliance with a Great Power in generations — the end of Splendid Isolation.**

(12) Step 4 · The Entente Cordiale (8 April 1904)

- Prepared by **Edward VII's** visit to Paris (1903) and the French foreign minister **Delcassé**.
- France accepted British control of **Egypt**; Britain accepted French interests in **Morocco**; other colonial disputes settled.
- Not an alliance, but strengthened by the **First Moroccan Crisis** (1905–06) and **Algeiras** (1906), after which British and French military staffs began secret talks.

(13) Step 5 · The Anglo-Russian Convention (31 August 1907)

- Signed by **Sir Edward Grey**.
- **Persia** divided into spheres of influence; **Afghanistan** British; **Tibet** neutral — the end of the **Great Game**.
- With France and Russia already allied, the **Triple Entente** faced the **Triple Alliance**.

(14) Analysis

- **Isolation was never total**: the Mediterranean Agreements and colonial treaties show Britain always made arrangements when it needed them.
- **Abandoned by necessity, not choice**: Britain turned first to **Germany**; only when that failed did it settle with **Japan, France** and **Russia** — the powers that threatened its **empire**.
- **The agreements were imperial deals**: Egypt for Morocco; Persia and Afghanistan — but they gradually became **European** commitments against Germany.

VERDICT · Conclusion

Britain adopted Splendid Isolation after 1870 because its navy, island position, worldwide empire and economic strength made alliances unnecessary, and because Bismarck's Europe kept its own balance. When Germany's rise, the Franco-Russian alliance, colonial clashes and the Boer War left Britain dangerously alone, it abandoned isolation in stages — failing with Germany, then allying with Japan (1902) and reaching understandings with France (1904) and Russia (1907). By 1907 Britain was part of the Triple Entente, and the road that would lead it into the First World War had been opened.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Definition first, including that isolation was **not total** · **Limb 1** gives **six reasons**, grouped · **Limb 2** explains **why** isolation became dangerous and then the **steps** of abandonment, **dated** · the answer notes that the process ran past **1900** — showing precise knowledge · a genuine **analysis** section.

Answer 9 · How Britain Halted Splendid Isolation — Its Positive and Negative Aspects

THE QUESTION · CSS 2018 · Q6 · Section B · 20 marks

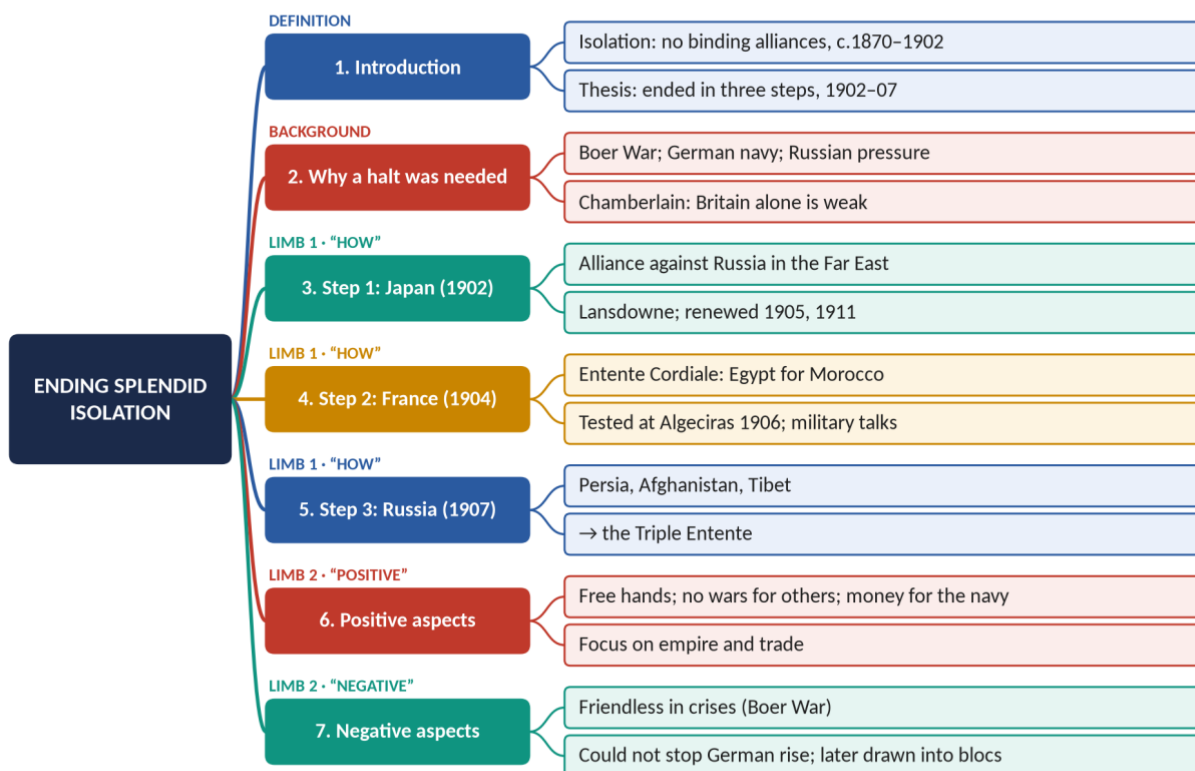
How did Britain put a halt to the Policy of Splendid Isolation? What were its positive and negative aspects?

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2018 · Q6 · SECTION B

How did Britain put a halt to the Policy of Splendid Isolation? What were its positive and negative aspects?

KEY WORDS "How did Britain put a halt" · "positive aspects" · "negative aspects"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) The steps by which isolation was ended, 1898–1907. (2) The good and bad sides of isolation itself (and, briefly, of ending it).



VERDICT

Britain ended isolation through the Japanese alliance and the ententes with France and Russia; isolation had given freedom and economy, but by 1900 it meant dangerous loneliness.

Figure 15 · The answer map for CSS 2018 · Q6 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "How did Britain put a halt to the Policy of Splendid Isolation?" — the **steps** of ending it (1898–1907). (2) "What were its positive and negative aspects?" — "**its**" means the **policy of isolation** itself: what was good and what was bad about it. Adding a short note on the positive and negative results of **ending** it shows depth.

The model answer

Introduction

Splendid Isolation — Britain's avoidance of permanent peacetime alliances with the Great Powers, associated with **Lord Salisbury** — lasted roughly from **1870 to 1902**. Britain put a halt to it in **three main steps**: the **Anglo-Japanese Alliance (1902)**, the **Entente Cordiale** with France (**1904**) and the **Anglo-Russian Convention (1907)**. The policy had real **advantages** — freedom, economy and peace — but by the 1890s its **disadvantages** — loneliness in a hostile world — had become dangerous.

Limb 1 · How Britain put a halt to isolation

(1) The pressures that forced a change

- **The Boer War (1899–1902)**: Britain fought for three years with almost every European power openly hostile; its army was stretched and humiliated in "Black Week" (1899).
- **Germany**: the **Kruger telegram** (1896) and the **Navy Laws** of **1898** and **1900** — a battle fleet in the North Sea could only be aimed at Britain.
- **Russia** in **China** and Central Asia; **France** in Africa (**Fashoda**, 1898); both **allied** since **1894**.
- **Over-stretch**: the navy could not be strong everywhere at once.

(2) The first attempt: Germany (1898–1901)

Joseph Chamberlain proposed an Anglo-German alliance three times. Germany wanted Britain to join the **Triple Alliance** without concessions and did not believe Britain could come to terms with France or Russia. The failure pushed Britain elsewhere.

(3) Step 1 · The Anglo-Japanese Alliance (1902)

- **Signed** on **30 January 1902** by **Lord Lansdowne** and the Japanese ambassador Hayashi.
- **Terms**: each would stay **neutral** if the other fought **one** power in the Far East, and **help** if it fought **two**.
- **Why**: to check **Russia** in China and Korea, and to let Britain bring warships home.
- **Result**: Japan defeated Russia in **1904–05** without French intervention; the alliance was renewed (**1905, 1911**).

(4) Step 2 · The Entente Cordiale (1904)

- **Prepared** by King **Edward VII**'s visit to Paris (**May 1903**) and **Delcassé**'s diplomacy.
- **Signed** on **8 April 1904**: **Egypt** for Britain, **Morocco** for France; Newfoundland, Siam and the New Hebrides settled.
- **Tested** by Germany in the **First Moroccan Crisis (1905)**, the Kaiser at **Tangier**; at **Algeciras (1906)** Britain stood by France; secret **Anglo-French military conversations** began.

(5) Step 3 · The Anglo-Russian Convention (1907)

- **Signed** on **31 August 1907** by **Sir Edward Grey**.
- **Persia** divided into Russian, British and neutral zones; **Afghanistan** a British sphere; **Tibet** neutral.
- **Result**: the **Great Game** ended; with France already allied to Russia, the **Triple Entente** was formed.

(6) Also: friendship with the USA

The **Hay–Pauncefote Treaty** (1901) removed the last serious quarrel with the United States.

Year	Agreement	What it did
1901	Hay–Pauncefote	Friendship with the USA
1902	Anglo-Japanese Alliance	Ally in the Far East against Russia
1904	Entente Cordiale	Colonial settlement with France
1907	Anglo-Russian Convention	Colonial settlement with Russia → Triple Entente

Limb 2 · Positive and negative aspects of Splendid Isolation

(7) Positive aspects

1. **Freedom of action** ("free hands"): Britain could judge each crisis by its own interests, without being bound by allies.
2. **Peace**: Britain avoided every European war between **1856** and **1914** — the Franco-Prussian, Austro-Prussian and Russo-Turkish wars.
3. **Economy**: no need for a large continental army; money went to the **navy** (the Two-Power Standard, 1889), which protected trade and empire.
4. **Focus on empire and trade**: Britain built the largest empire in history.
5. **Bargaining power**: others courted Britain; it could make **limited** deals when needed (Mediterranean Agreements, 1887; Heligoland–Zanzibar, 1890).
6. **Democratic control**: no secret treaties committing a future Parliament to war.

(8) Negative aspects

1. **No friends in a crisis:** in **1895–1902** Britain quarrelled with the USA (**Venezuela**), Germany (**Kruger telegram**), France (**Fashoda**) and Russia (China) — and in the **Boer War** stood alone against a hostile Europe.
2. **No influence over the alliance systems:** Britain could not shape or restrain the **Triple Alliance** or the **Franco-Russian alliance**.
3. **Could not deter Germany:** isolation allowed Germany to believe it could build a navy against Britain without consequence.
4. **Over-stretch:** a world-wide empire defended alone strained the navy and the army.
5. **Complacency:** it hid Britain's **relative decline** as the USA and Germany overtook it industrially.

(9) Positive and negative results of ending it

- **Positive:** security in the Far East and Mediterranean; colonial disputes with France and Russia settled; the navy concentrated in the **North Sea**.
- **Negative:** Britain drawn into **rival blocs**; Germany felt **encircled**; secret military talks created a moral obligation to France — part of the road to **1914**.

VERDICT · Conclusion

Britain put a halt to Splendid Isolation in stages — after failing to ally with Germany, it allied with Japan in 1902 and reached ententes with France in 1904 and Russia in 1907. Isolation had served Britain well while it was unchallenged, giving it freedom, peace and economy; but by the 1890s it left Britain friendless among rising rivals. Ending it brought security but at the price of entanglement in the alliance systems that led to the First World War.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Limb 1 explains the **pressures** and then the **steps, dated** and summarised in a table · Limb 2 lists **six positive** and **five negative** aspects of the **policy itself**, as "its" requires · a brief section on the **results of ending it** adds depth · a balanced verdict.

Answer 10 · Splendid Isolation: Why It Began, and Was It Right?

THE QUESTION · CSS 2023 · Q4 · Section A · 20 marks

Why did Britain initiate the Policy of Splendid Isolation? What is your personal opinion whether it was a right step in the right direction or proved detrimental?

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2023 · Q4 · SECTION A

Why did Britain initiate the Policy of Splendid Isolation? What is your personal opinion whether it was a right step in the right direction or proved detrimental?

KEY WORDS "Why did Britain initiate" · "your personal opinion" · "right step" · "detrimental"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Reasons for the policy. (2) Your own reasoned opinion — right or harmful? Use "I argue that..." and support it with evidence on both sides.



VERDICT

In my opinion Splendid Isolation was a right step while Britain was unchallenged, but it became detrimental once several rivals rose at once — and Britain was right to abandon it.

Figure 16 · The answer map for CSS 2023 · Q4 · Section A: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "Why did Britain initiate the Policy of Splendid Isolation?" — the reasons. (2) "What is your personal opinion whether it was a right step in the right direction or proved detrimental?" — you must give **your own view**, clearly, in the first person ("In my opinion...", "I argue..."), and **support it** with evidence, while fairly considering the other side. A sensible opinion often distinguishes **periods**.

The model answer

Introduction

Splendid Isolation was Britain's policy, from about **1870** to **1902**, of refusing to join permanent peacetime alliances with other Great Powers. It is linked with **Lord Salisbury**, who described Britain's diplomacy as "floating lazily downstream". Britain initiated it because its **navy, island position, empire** and **wealth** made alliances seem unnecessary, and because the European balance was kept by others. **In my opinion**, isolation was **a right step** while Britain was unchallenged — until about **1895** — but it became **detrimental** once several rivals rose at the same time; Britain was then right to abandon it.

Limb 1 · Why Britain initiated the policy

(1) Geography and sea power

- **An island**: protected by the Channel from invasion.
- **The Royal Navy**: the largest in the world; the **Two-Power Standard (1889)** kept it as strong as the next two navies combined.

(2) Economic and imperial strength

- Britain was the world's leading **trading** and **financial** power, with the largest **empire**. Its interests lay across the oceans, not on the continent.
- A large army for continental alliances would be costly and unnecessary.

(3) The European situation after 1870

- **German unification** (1871) created a new balance. **Bismarck** wanted peace and built alliances that kept Europe stable.
- Britain could leave the continental balance to others and intervene only if it was seriously threatened.

(4) Freedom of action

- British governments wanted "**free hands**" to deal with each issue according to British interests.
- **Parliament** and public opinion disliked **secret treaties** that might commit Britain to war in the future — Salisbury argued no government could bind a future Parliament.

(5) Lessons of the past

- **The Crimean War** (1854–56), costly and of doubtful value, discouraged involvement in continental quarrels.
- The **Congress system** after 1815 had shown the danger of being tied to autocratic allies.

Limb 2 · My opinion — right step or detrimental?

(6) Why I think it was a right step (c.1870–1895)

1. **It kept Britain out of wars:** Britain fought no European war from **1856** to **1914**, while France, Austria, Prussia, Russia and Turkey fought several.
2. **It suited Britain's strength:** with the strongest navy and economy, Britain did not need allies to be safe.
3. **It saved money:** resources went into the **navy** and the **empire**, which grew enormously.
4. **It kept Britain's freedom:** Britain could bargain with all sides and make **limited** agreements when useful — the **Mediterranean Agreements (1887)** and the **Heligoland–Zanzibar Treaty (1890)**.
5. **It respected Parliament:** no secret commitments to war.

(7) Why I think it became detrimental (c.1895–1902)

1. **Friendless in crises:** in a few years Britain quarrelled with the **USA** (Venezuela, 1895), **Germany** (the Kruger telegram, 1896), **France** (Fashoda, 1898) and **Russia** (China). During the **Boer War** (1899–1902) Europe was openly hostile.
2. **Rival alliances:** the **Franco-Russian alliance** (1894) and the **Triple Alliance** left Britain outside both blocs, with no influence over either.
3. **The German navy:** the **Navy Laws** of **1898** and **1900** threatened Britain's naval supremacy; alone, Britain could not both match Germany in the North Sea and guard its empire.
4. **Over-stretch and relative decline:** the USA and Germany had overtaken British industry; Britain could no longer afford to stand alone.

(8) Considering the opposite view

- Some argue that isolation was **always** a mistake — it let the continental alliances form without Britain and encouraged Germany's ambitions. **But** in the 1870s and 1880s Britain faced no serious threat, and alliances would only have dragged it into others' quarrels.
- Others argue that **ending** isolation was the real mistake, because the ententes drew Britain into the **First World War**. **But** by 1902 isolation could no longer protect the empire, and the agreements with Japan, France and Russia were mainly **colonial** settlements that solved real dangers.

(9) My judgement

Period	My assessment
c.1870–1895	A right step: peace, freedom, economy; Britain unchallenged
c.1895–1902	Detrimental: several rivals at once; the Boer War; the German navy
1902–1907	Rightly abandoned: Japan, France, Russia — though at the cost of entanglement

VERDICT · Conclusion

Britain initiated Splendid Isolation because its island position, naval supremacy, empire and wealth made alliances unnecessary, and because Bismarck's Europe kept its own balance. In my opinion, it was a right step in the right direction for as long as those conditions lasted: it kept Britain at peace, free and prosperous. But by the late 1890s, faced with a hostile Europe, a German navy and an over-stretched empire, it had become detrimental, and Britain was right to abandon it for the alliance with Japan and the ententes with France and Russia.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Limb 1 gives **grouped reasons** · Limb 2 gives a **clear personal opinion** in the first person, as the question demands, **supported with evidence** · it **considers the opposite view** fairly · a **period-by-period table** makes the judgement precise · the conclusion restates the opinion confidently.

Part Two — The Past MCQs, Solved

CSS 2024 · MCQ 2

The British colony of Singapore was established as a trading post along which important maritime route?

(A) Suez Canal	(B) Strait of Malacca	(C) Cape of Good Hope	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: B. Strait of Malacca

Singapore was founded in **1819** by **Sir Stamford Raffles** as a trading post on the **Strait of Malacca** — the narrow sea route between the Indian Ocean and the South China Sea.

CSS 2024 · MCQ 3

The “Scramble for Africa” refers to the period of intense European colonial expansion in Africa during which centuries?

(A) 18th and 19th	(B) 17th and 18th	(C) 19th and 20th	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: C. 19th and 20th centuries

The **Scramble for Africa** ran from about **1881 to 1914** — so it covers the **19th and 20th centuries**. By 1914 Europeans controlled about 90 per cent of Africa.

CSS 2024 · MCQ 17

The early Victorian Anglo-Russian rivalry known as the “Great Game” was:

(A) The Boer War	(B) The Civil War	(C) The Crimean War	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: D. None of these — it was a wider geopolitical rivalry in Central Asia

The **Great Game** was the long **Anglo-Russian rivalry for influence in Central Asia** (Afghanistan, Persia, Tibet), c.1830–1907 — not the Boer War, the Civil War or the Crimean War. So the key is "None of these".

CSS 2026 · MCQ 17

The Crimean War was fought by Britain against:

(A) Russia	(B) France	(C) The Ottoman Empire	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: A. Russia

Britain (with France, the Ottoman Empire and Sardinia) fought the Crimean War (1853–56) against **Russia**.

Part Three — Five Predicted Questions, with Outlines

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Why these five

They cover large parts of syllabus Heads IX–X that **have not yet been set** as full questions — and the MCQs of 2024 show the examiner has begun to test the **empire**.

Predicted 1 · "Compare the foreign policies of Castlereagh and Canning."

- **Introduction:** both Tories under Liverpool; both defended British interests; different styles.
- **Castlereagh:** Vienna settlement; Quadruple Alliance; congresses; **State Paper 1820**; worked quietly inside the Concert.
- **Canning:** broke with the Congress system (Verona 1822); Latin America recognised; Portugal 1826; Greece and **Navarino** 1827; appeal to public opinion.
- **Continuity:** non-intervention in others' internal affairs; balance of power; trade.
- **Verdict:** a difference of **method and tone** more than of aims.

Predicted 2 · "Discuss the causes of the Scramble for Africa and Britain's role in it."

- **Causes:** economic (raw materials, markets), strategic (Egypt, Suez, the Cape), rivalry and prestige (Germany, France, Italy), technology (steamships, quinine, Maxim gun), ideas (missionaries, Social Darwinism).
- **Berlin Conference 1884–85.**
- **Britain's role:** Egypt 1882; Sudan (Gordon 1885; Omdurman 1898); Nigeria, Gold Coast; Kenya, Uganda; Rhodes and Rhodesia; Fashoda 1898; Boer War 1899–1902.
- **Verdict:** Britain gained the largest and richest share, driven mainly by the route to India (Robinson and Gallagher).

Predicted 3 · "Examine the causes and consequences of the Boer War (1899–1902)."

- **Causes:** gold on the Rand (1886); the Uitlanders; Kruger; Rhodes and the **Jameson Raid** (1895–96); the **Kruger telegram**; Milner and Chamberlain's pressure.
- **Course:** Black Week; sieges (Ladysmith, Kimberley, Mafeking); Roberts and Kitchener; guerrilla war; concentration camps.
- **Consequences:** Vereeniging 1902; Union of South Africa 1910; ~22,000 British dead, £200m; army reform (Haldane); national efficiency; the end of Splendid Isolation.

Predicted 4 · "Discuss the causes and results of the Indian Mutiny of 1857."

- **Causes:** political (Dalhousie's annexations, Doctrine of Lapse, Awadh), religious (fear of conversion; the cartridges), economic (land revenue), military (sepoy grievances).
- **Course:** Meerut (10 May 1857); Delhi and Bahadur Shah; Lucknow; Cawnpore; recapture of Delhi.
- **Results:** Government of India Act 1858 — Crown rule, Secretary of State, Viceroy; the Queen's Proclamation; army reorganised; the end of the Mughals; racial distrust; roots of Indian nationalism.

Predicted 5 · "Trace British policy towards Egypt and the Sudan from 1875 to 1904."

- **1875** Suez shares; **1876** Dual Control; **1882** Urabi revolt, Alexandria, Tel-el-Kebir, occupation.
- **Cromer's rule** (1883–1907); the Mahdi; **Gordon** (1885); the Sudan abandoned.
- **Reconquest:** Kitchener, **Omdurman** 1898; **Fashoda** 1898; Anglo-Egyptian condominium (1899).
- **1904** Entente Cordiale: France accepts British Egypt.
- **Verdict:** the route to India turned a financial interest into a lasting occupation (to 1956).